halo

BRAND BOOK · VERSION 1.0 · 2026

AI that feels like second nature.

CONTENTS

Light, not machinery.

A halo is soft light that surrounds you. It doesn't ask for attention, it helps you see. This book shows how Halo looks, sounds and speaks, so every touchpoint feels like the same calm, capable companion.

01 Mission, audience & principles

02 The Open Ring — logo system

03 Color & accessibility

04 Typography

05 Voice, tone & sound

06 Imagery & visual language

07 Applications

08 In-app system — icons, presence & surfaces

01 · MISSION

Make technology feel like a natural extension of what you can do.

Halo is an open-source, privacy-first personal cognitive assistant. It connects voice, vision, memory, everyday tasks, phone controls and wearables into one experience. It runs on your device first and reaches for the cloud only when you choose.

On-device first | Open source | Your data stays yours

Everyone. Starting with the curious.

Now

Early adopters

Alpha testers, open-source contributors, makers and tinkerers who want to shape a genuinely useful assistant.

Next

Everyday people

Students, families and privacy-conscious users who want AI that actually helps with daily life.

Always

The not-so-techy

Children, older adults and anyone who finds tech intimidating. If they feel at home, everyone does.

Design test: could a 9-year-old and a 79-year-old both understand this at a glance? If not, simplify.

01 · BRAND PRINCIPLES

Three words. Every decision.

Futuristic

Technology from tomorrow, shown with restraint. Light, glow and space instead of circuits and chrome.

Human

Warm, honest and a little playful. Halo shows its results and its failures. It talks like a friend, never a machine.

Effortless

Nothing to operate, nothing to decode. Fewer words, bigger type, one clear action at a time.

We are **not**: robotic · mystical · corporate · hype-driven · intimidating

Our primary logo.



PRIMARY LOCKUP — MINT GRADIENT RING + NIGHT INK WORDMARK ON CREAM

02 · WHAT THE MARK MEANS

An open circle.

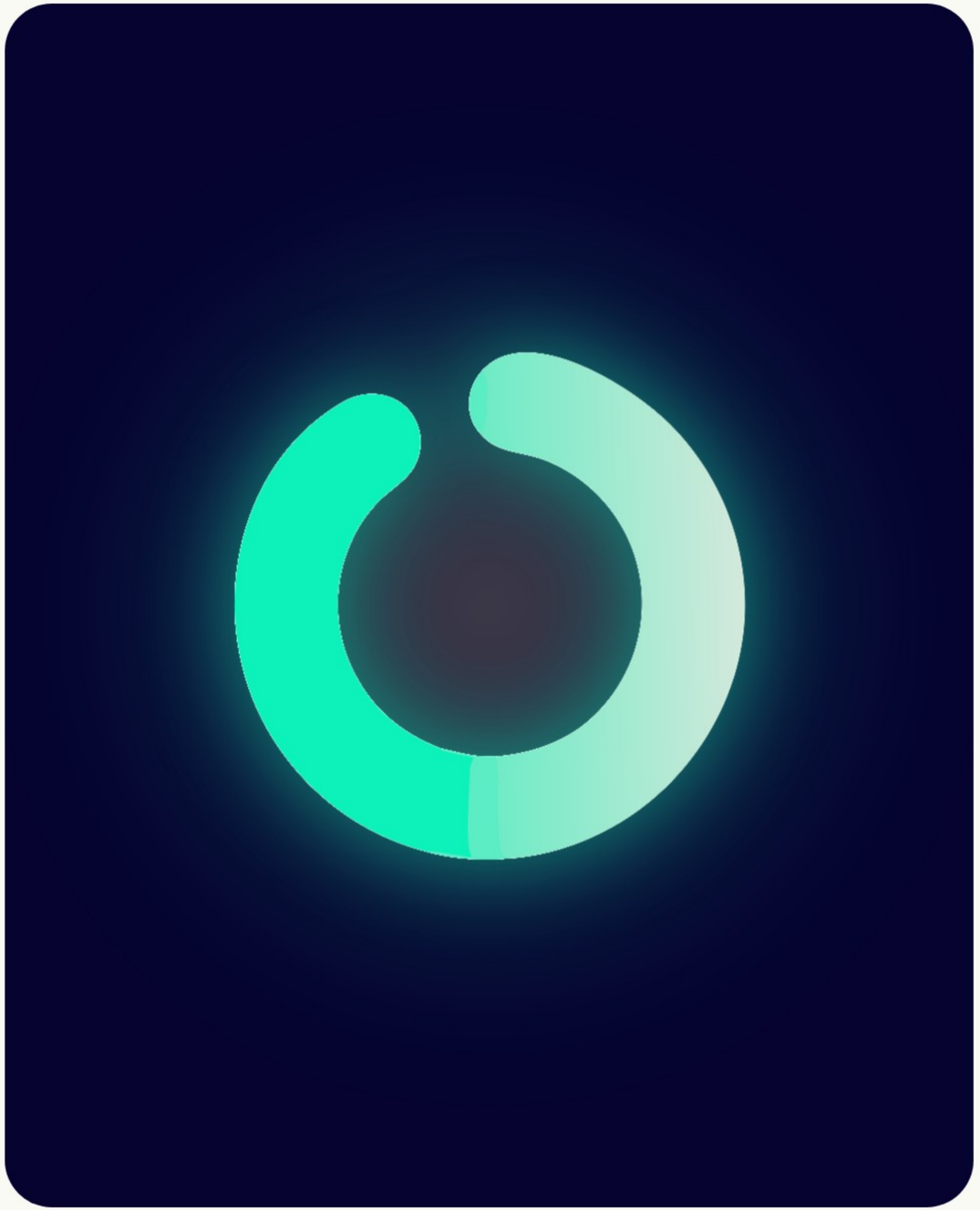
A closed ring is a boundary. Ours is open on purpose.

The gap = open source. Halo is built in the open, with room for anyone to contribute.

The ring = a halo of light. Help that surrounds you quietly, instead of a screen you stare at.

The gradient = on-device to cloud. Bright and close at the core, softer as it reaches outward.

Rounded ends = human. No sharp edges, nothing robotic.



02 · CLEAR SPACE & MINIMUM SIZE

Give it room to glow.

Keep clear space on all sides equal to the ring's stroke height × 2 — marked **x**. Nothing enters this zone: no text, edges or other logos.



FULL LOCKUP

halo

120 px digital
30 mm print

RING ALONE

24 px digital
8 mm print

One mark, four ways.



Primary
Default for light surfaces.



Reversed
Night Ink and dark photography.



Mono
One-color print, engraving, stamps.



App icon
Launcher, favicon, avatars, glasses HUD.

Please don't.



✕ Stretch or squash it



✕ Rotate it, or move the gap



✕ Recolor it outside the palette



✕ Place it on purple-blue "AI" gradients



✕ Add sparkles, stars or effects



✕ Retype the wordmark

Mint light on night ink.

Halo Mint

Primary
#0CF2BA · RGB 12 242 186
CMYK 64 0 41 0
Pantone 3385 C (nearest)

Night Ink

Secondary
#060330
RGB 6 3 48
CMYK 88 94 0 81
Pantone 2765 C

Deep Mint

Secondary
#047A5E
RGB 4 122 94
CMYK 97 0 23 52
Pantone 3415 C

Cream

Neutral
#FAFAF4
RGB 250 250 244
CMYK 0 0 2 2
Pantone 11-0601

Slate

Neutral
#4A4F63
RGB 74 79 99
CMYK 25 20 0 61
Pantone 7545 C

Sunrise Apricot

Accent
#FF9F6B
RGB 255 159 107
CMYK 0 38 58 0
Pantone 1565 C

Balance guide: Cream or Night Ink ~70% · Mint ~20% · Deep Mint & Slate for text · Apricot ≤5%, for warmth only. Tint: Mist #B4E6D6 (ring gradient end).

03 · ACCESSIBILITY

Every pair, checked.

WCAG 2.2 contrast. AA needs 4.5:1 for body text, 3:1 for large text.

Aa
Ink on Cream
18.9 : 1 · AAA

Aa
Ink on Mint
13.6 : 1 · AAA

Aa
Apricot on Ink
9.8 : 1 · AAA

Aa
Mint on Ink
13.6 : 1 · AAA

Aa
Slate on Cream
7.7 : 1 · AAA

Aa
Deep Mint on Cream
5.1 : 1 · AA

Aa
Mint on Cream
1.4 : 1 · FAIL

Aa
Apricot on Cream
1.9 : 1 · FAIL

Rule: Mint and Apricot are light, never text on light surfaces. For mint-colored text on Cream, use Deep Mint. Never convey meaning by color alone.

Aa

Sora

Display & headlines · Light 300 → ExtraBold 800

Geometric and forward-looking, with round friendly forms that echo the ring.

ABCDEFGHIJKLMNOPQRSTUVWXYZ

abcdefghijklmnopqrstuvwxyz 0123456789

Aa

Atkinson Hyperlegible Next

Body, UI & captions · Regular 400, Bold 700

Designed for readers with low vision: every letter is distinct (Il1, O0).

Accessibility, built into the brand.

ABCDEFGHIJKLMNOPQRSTUVWXYZ

abcdefghijklmnopqrstuvwxyz 0123456789

Display · Sora 700
72 / 1.05 · –2%

Ask anything. Out loud.

Heading · Sora 600
40 / 1.15

Your notes, remembered for you

Body · Atkinson 400
20 / 1.6

Halo runs on your phone first. When a question needs more power, you decide whether it reaches the cloud — and you can always see what was shared.

Label · Sora 600
14 · +22% · caps

OPEN SOURCE · ANDROID ALPHA

Button · Sora 600
18

Try the alpha View source

Minimum body size: 16 px on screen, 10 pt in print. Sentence case everywhere. Never all-caps for more than three words.

A thoughtful friend who knows a lot.

Warm

We sound glad to help. Never cold, never transactional.

Clear

Short sentences, plain words. If a child can't follow it, rewrite it.

Honest

We say what Halo can and can't do yet. Failures are shown, not hidden.

Lightly playful

A smile, not a joke. Delight in the details, never at the user's expense.

Tone shifts with the moment: **celebratory** for wins, **calm and precise** for errors and privacy, **inviting** for contributors.

05 · SAY IT LIKE HALO

Do / Don't.

DO

"Done — your alarm is set for 7:00. Sleep well."

DON'T

"Task executed successfully. Alarm parameter configured."

DO

"I couldn't open that app. Want me to try another way?"

DON'T

"Error 403: Action not permitted."

DO

"This stays on your phone. Nothing is sent anywhere."

DON'T

"Revolutionary AGI-powered magic that changes everything!"

Avoid: "magic", "revolutionary", "AGI", "unleash", "seamless", jargon, fear-based privacy messaging.

The Halo voice.

A custom-designed brand voice: warm, calm and unhurried, with a soft smile in it. Neutral international English, crisp articulation that children, older adults and non-native listeners can follow easily.

Pace: unhurried, natural pauses

Pitch: gentle mid-range, gender-neutral leaning

Feel: reassuring, lightly playful, never robotic

Use for: onboarding, product videos, tutorials, voice replies



VOICE SAMPLE AVAILABLE IN THE HALO BRAND KIT

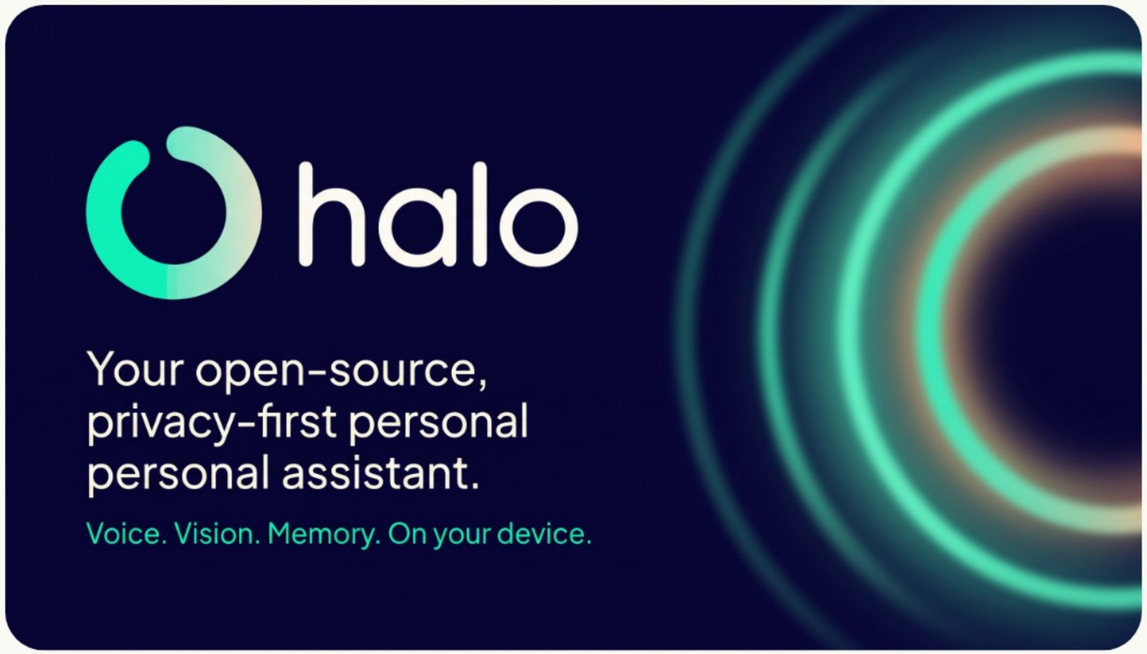
Show the light, not the machine.

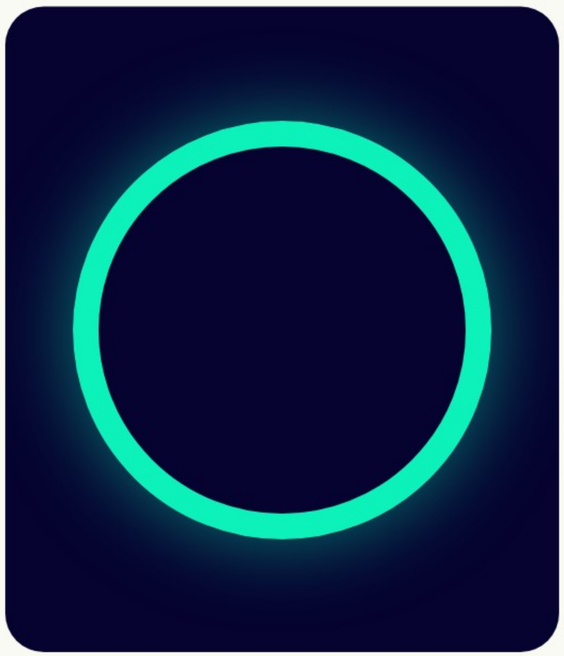
Motif: soft mint rings and glows that radiate, ripple or frame. Always calm, never busy.

Photography: real people in everyday moments — kitchens, buses, classrooms, workbenches. Natural window light, warm tones, Halo present but in the background.

Surfaces: Cream paper and stone in daylight; Night Ink for evening and focus.

Never: robots, glowing brains, circuit boards, sparkles, holograms, purple-blue neural gradients.





07 · APPLICATIONS

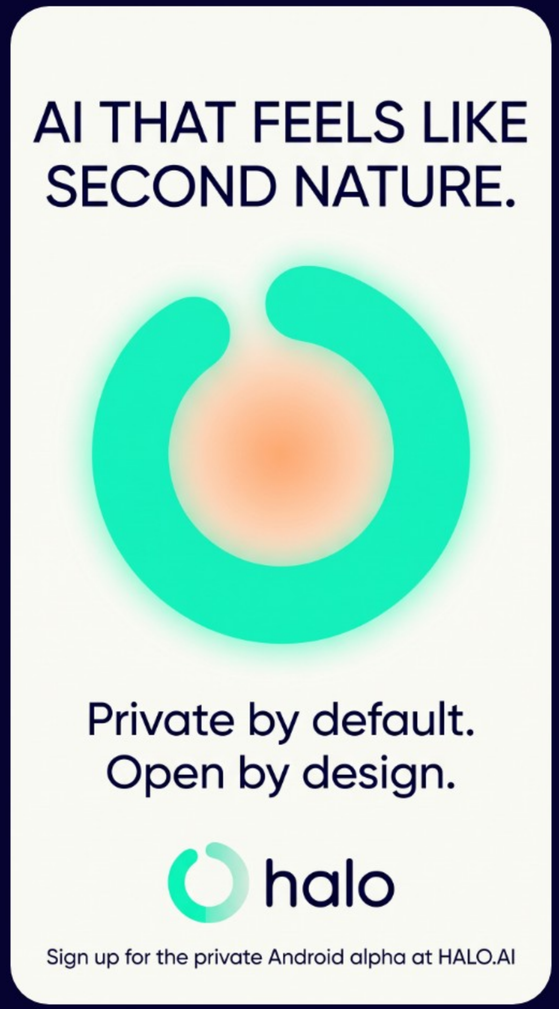
In the hand.





On every screen.









08 · IN-APP SYSTEM

The ring comes alive.

Inside the app, the Open Ring becomes Halo's body language. Its gap rests, travels, closes and calls for you. Icons share the same hand, and every surface, from the 16dp notification to the full-screen orb, speaks one visual language.

85 icons · 24dp · 1.75 stroke

21 presence states · 15 animated

3 layers · 4 sizes · Mini Halo, Floating Halo, widgets, launcher



HALO IN-APP SYSTEM · 01

Icon system

24dp grid · 1.75 stroke · round caps & joins · 2–4.5 radius corners. Every circle carries the Open Ring gap at upper right. Active = Mint dot in the corner, never color alone.

NAVIGATION


home


activity


notebook


devices


settings

LAYER 2 · CONTEXT & EXECUTION


on-device


lan


cloud


glasses


mic


camera


tool


memory


phone-action

LAYER 3 · CONDITIONS


approval


permission


failure


battery-low


disconnected


unavailable


automation


retry


download

ON NIGHT INK · ACTIVE STATES


home · active


activity


notebook


devices


settings



HALO IN-APP SYSTEM · ICON LIBRARY

85 icons, one hand

24dp · 1.75 stroke · round. Every circle keeps the Open Ring gap. AI-assisted actions carry a small open ring (ai-draft, ai-organize, intelligence).

NAVIGATION

home · activity · notebook · devices · settings

NOTEBOOK & CANVAS

canvas · study · memory · conversations · inbox · new-note

new-canvas · import · export · search · favorite · collections

sort · archive · trash · multi-select · tag · link

group · draw · annotate · ocr · transcribe · ai-draft

ai-organize

HOME & ASSISTANT

send · stop · mic · camera · attach · image

timer · open-app · new-chat · ask-mode · action-mode · reminder

task

SETTINGS

intelligence · model · voice · language · appearance · accent

kids-mode · privacy · permission · skills · integrations · automation

routines · storage · backup · guided-setup · diagnostics · lab

runtime-status

DEVICES & HARDWARE

phone · glasses · watch · headphones · speaker · robot

bluetooth · add-device · battery-low · disconnected

HALO SURFACES

mini-halo · floating · widget

CONTEXT (LAYER 2)

on-device · lan · cloud · glasses · mic · camera

tool · memory · phone-action

CONDITIONS (LAYER 3)

approval · permission · failure · battery-low · disconnected · unavailable

automation · retry · download

HALO IN-APP SYSTEM · 02

Halo presence states

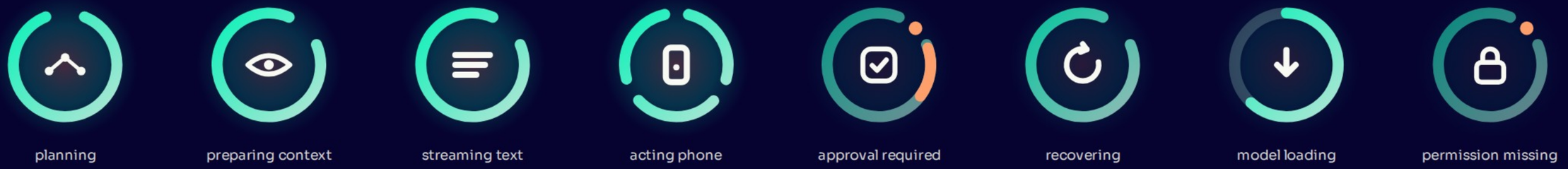
Layer 1. One ring, one gap: the gap travels when Halo thinks, closes when a task completes, and turns Apricot when Halo needs you. Error is the only Ember moment, and always pairs with a glyph.

CORE · 12 + VISION SPLIT





RUNTIME EXTRAS



HALO IN-APP SYSTEM · 03

Three layers, four sizes

State (Layer 1) never changes because of where AI runs. Context badge sits bottom-right, condition badge bottom-left: independent dimensions, composed at runtime.



Thinking · on-device



Speaking · after cloud reply



Phone action · LAN · needs approval



Listening via glasses · battery low

SIZE LADDER



Hero

160–240dp · full motion, glow, ripples



Standard

80–120dp · Home, Mini Halo



Compact

40–64dp · cards, overlays, floating



Micro

16–32dp · notifications

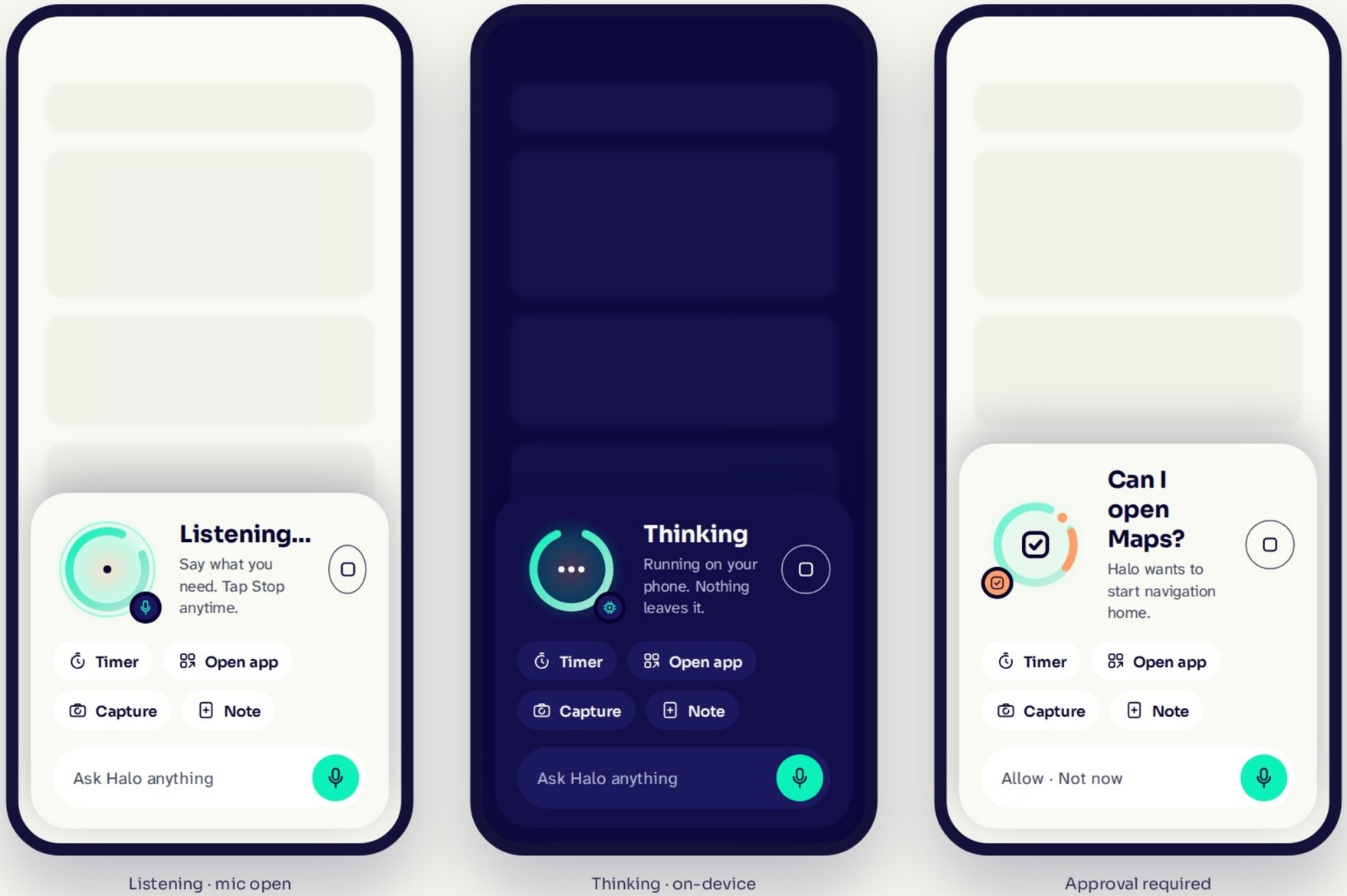


Micro reads by ring shape + color: idle · waiting · warning · error · offline · done

HALO SURFACES · MINI HALO

Mini Halo

The compact assistant: 88dp orb with full motion, live status in plain words, Stop always one tap away, quick tools as chips, mic as the primary action. Context and condition badges sit on the orb.



Listening · mic open

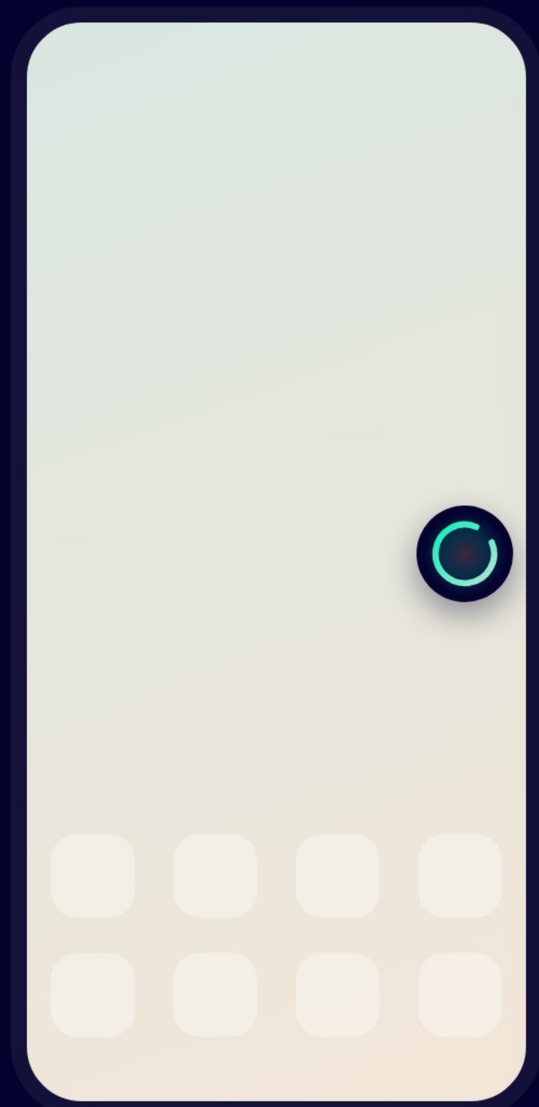
Thinking · on-device

Approval required

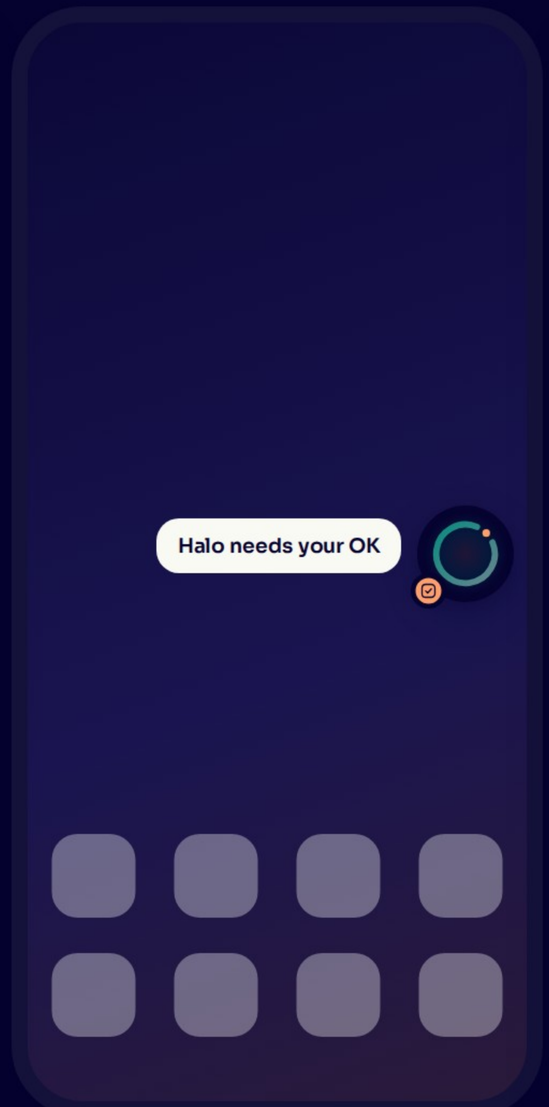
HALO SURFACES · FLOATING HALO & WIDGETS

Always near, never in the way

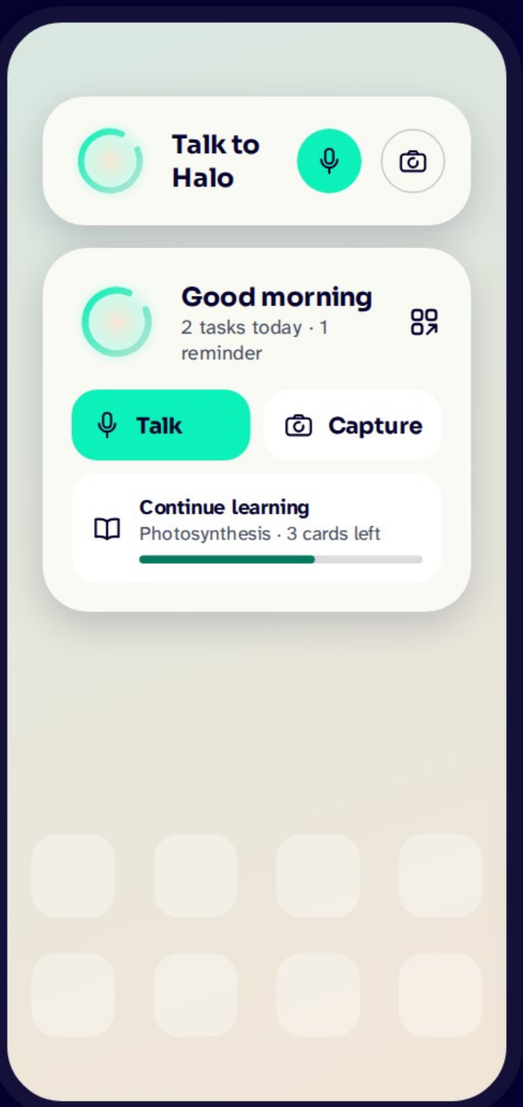
Floating Halo: a 56dp static orb on a Night Ink disc, docked to the screen edge; it shows a condition badge only when Halo truly needs you. Widgets: Talk and Capture first, continue learning second.



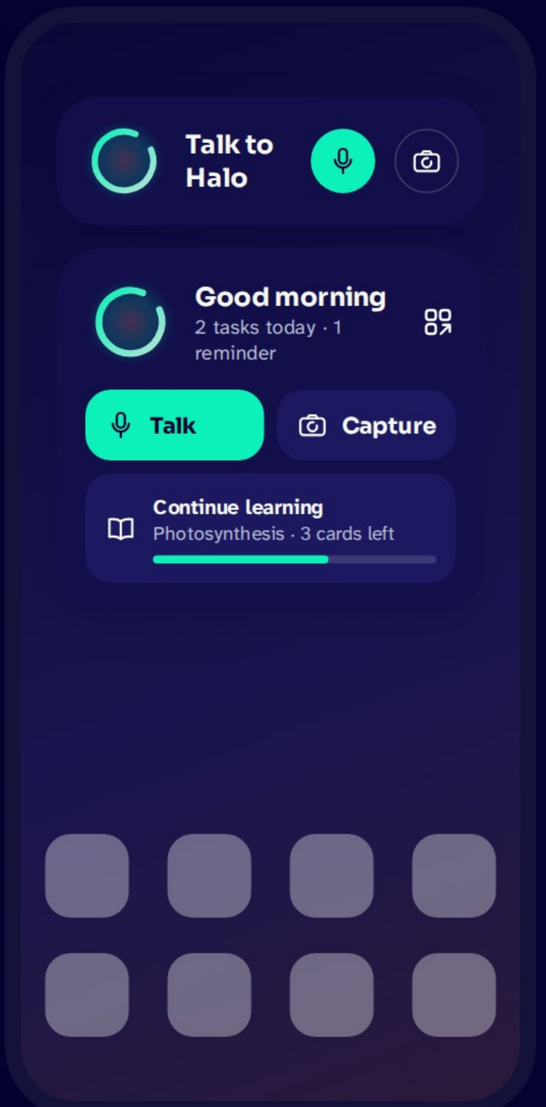
Floating · idle, docked



Floating · needs your OK



Widgets · light

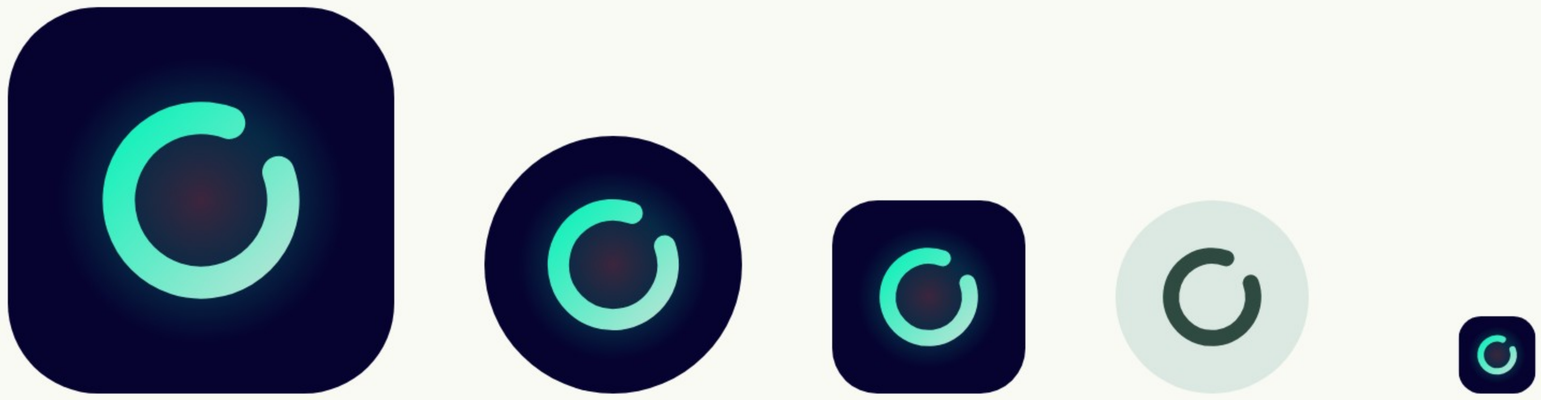


Widgets · dark

HALO SURFACES · LAUNCHER ICON

App icon

Adaptive icon: Mint ring foreground inside the 66dp safe zone, Night Ink background, and a monochrome layer for Android 13+ themed icons. The ring holds its shape in every mask.



Squircle mask · Circle mask · Rounded square · Themed (monochrome) · 48dp

DEVELOPER FILES

launcher/ic_launcher.xml (adaptive) · ic_launcher_foreground.xml · ic_launcher_monochrome.xml · ic_launcher_background.xml (#060330) · ic_launcher_full.svg (Play Store 512 source)

KIDS MODE · 01

Same Halo, a warmer hello.

Kids mode keeps every state and every honesty rule, then warms the ring with Apricot, thickens it by 25%, gives idle a smile, and speaks in short, kind sentences. Anything that acts on the phone asks a grown-up.



Hi! I'm here when you need me.

IDLE



I'm listening!

LISTENING



Hmm, let me think...

THINKING



On it!

ACTING



Here's what I found!

SPEAKING



I'm waiting for you.

WAITING



Can I do this? Ask a grown-up if you're not sure.

APPROVAL_REQUIRED



All done!

SUCCESS



Oops, something got in the way. Let's try again.

WARNING



That didn't work. It's okay, we can try again.

ERROR



I need a grown-up to say yes first.

PERMISSION_MISSING

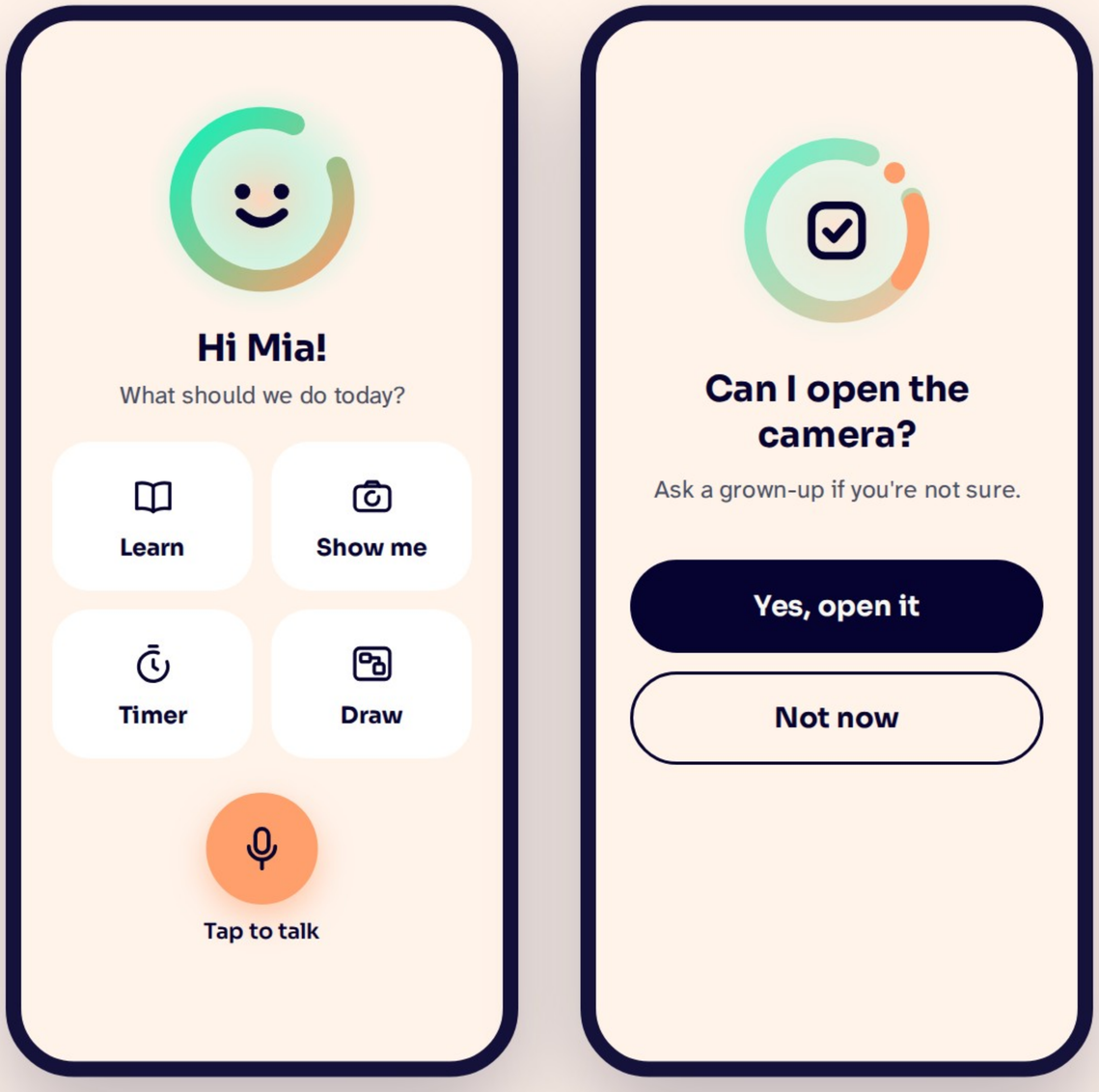


Okay, I stopped.

STOPPED

KIDS MODE · 02

Built for small hands.



Kids home

Grown-up check

Touch targets

56dp minimum, 72dp for the main mic button. Never two small buttons side by side.

Type

Body 18sp+, titles Sora 700 at 24sp+. One idea per screen, max 3 choices.

Color

Apricot leads for warmth and the main action. Text stays Night Ink on Cream: Apricot is never text on light.

Words

Short, kind and concrete. "Let's try again", never error codes. Say who decides: "Ask a grown-up".

Safety

Phone actions, camera and new permissions always ask. Provider, model and advanced settings are hidden behind a parent lock.

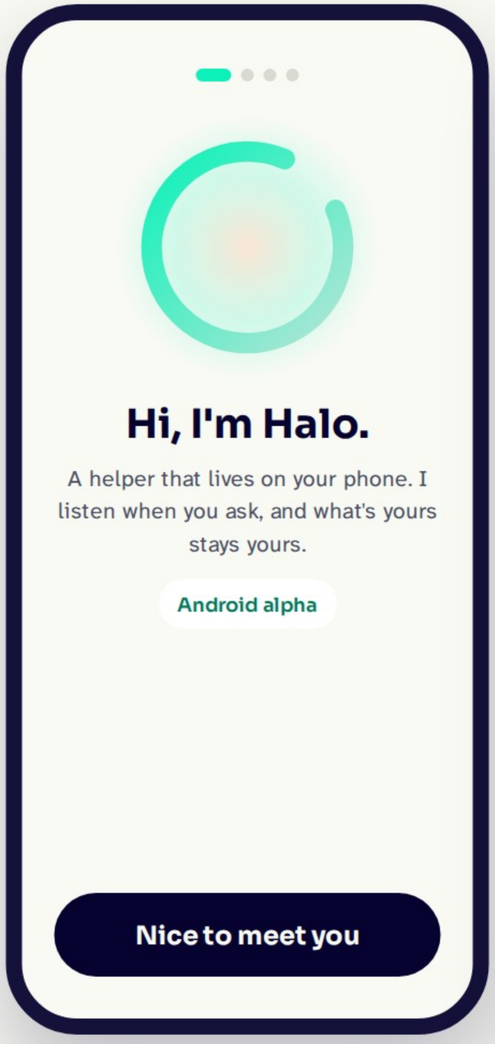
Honesty

Same rules as adult Halo: the mic and camera indicators show only while they're truly on.

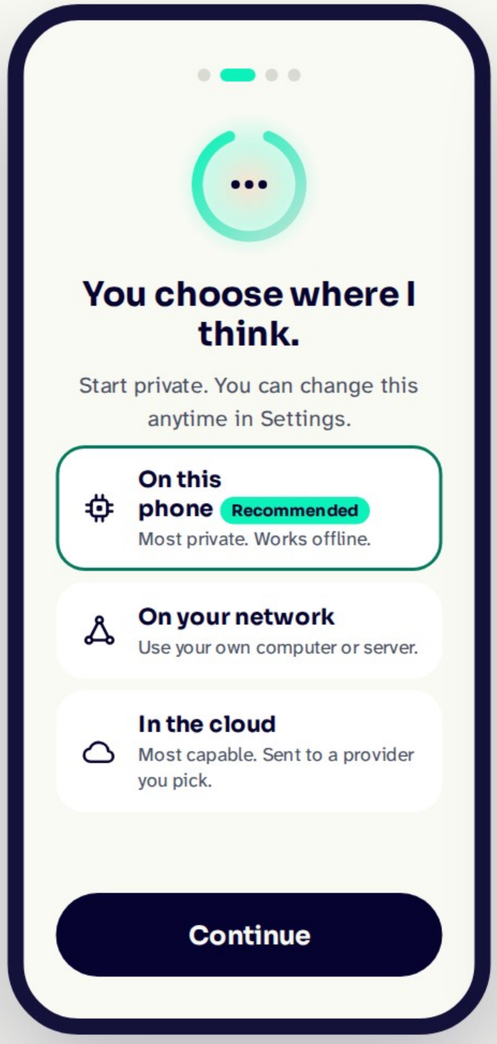
ALPHA ONBOARDING

Four screens to trust.

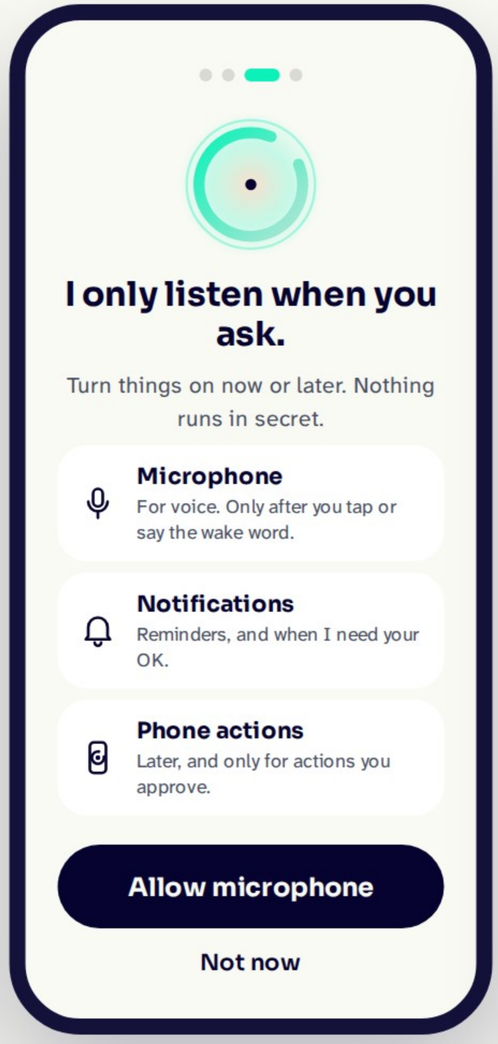
Hello, then choose where Halo thinks, then honest permissions, then the alpha invitation. Every screen shows the orb in the state it describes, and nothing is switched on without a tap.



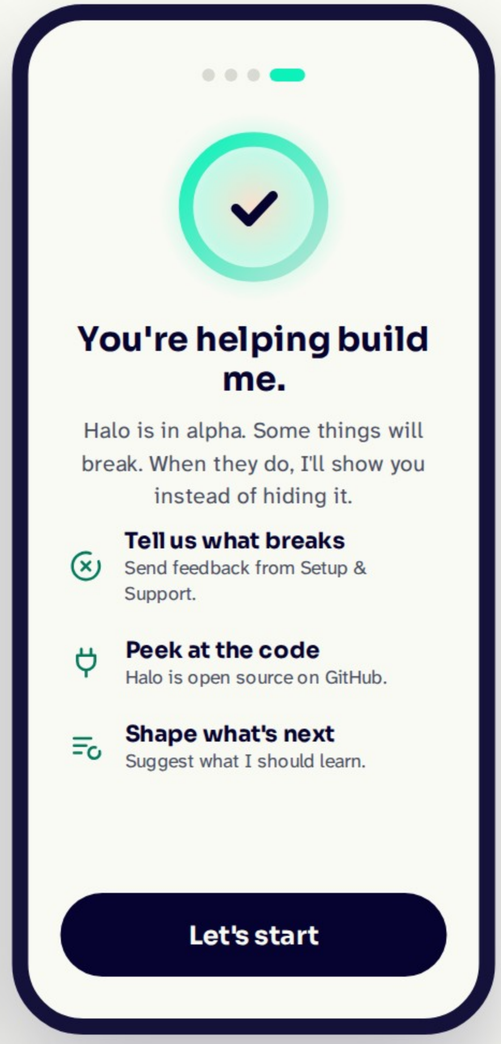
1 · Welcome



2 · Where



3 · Listen

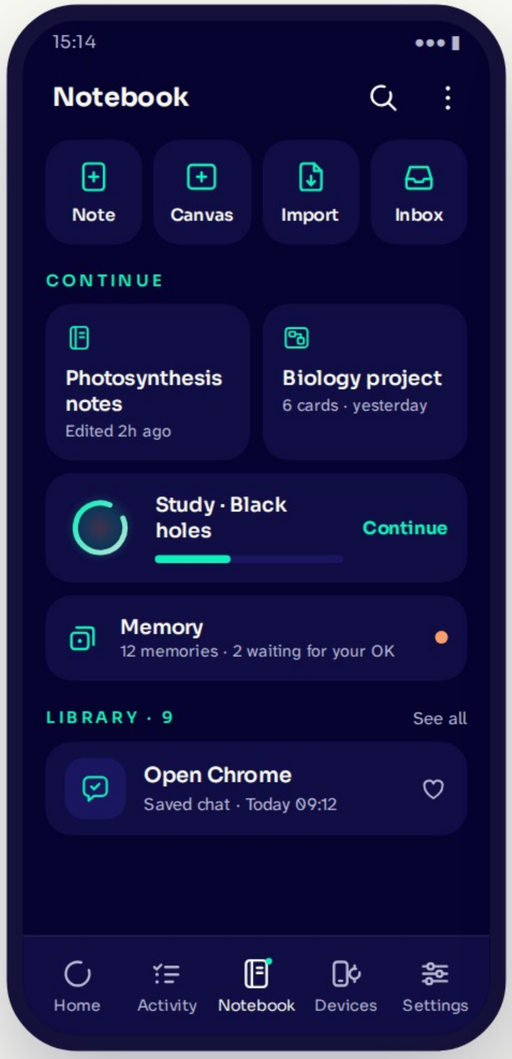


4 · Alpha

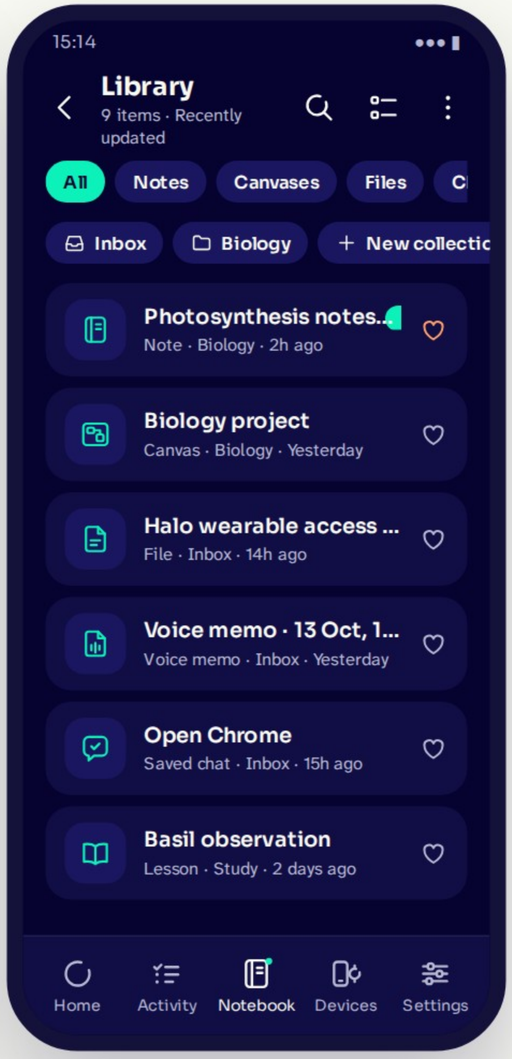
NOTEBOOK & TOOLS · 02

Notebook hub & Library

The hub becomes a launchpad: create in one tap, continue where you left off, and see Study and Memory at a glance. Skills moves out to Settings.

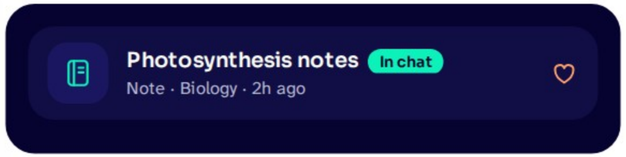


Notebook hub



Library

LIBRARY ITEM ANATOMY

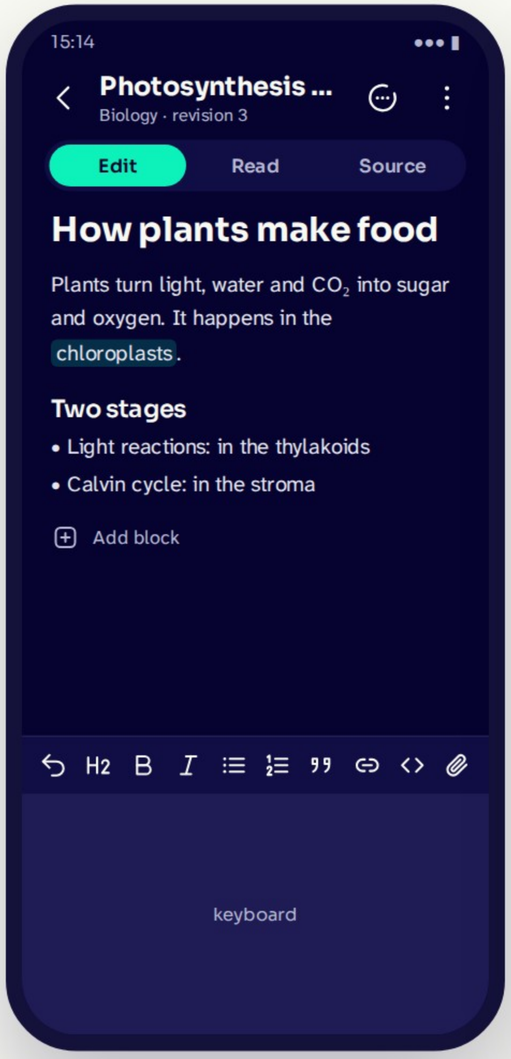


- **Type tile:** 38dp, Mint icon on Surface 2. The type is readable without color.
- **Title:** Sora 600/13, one line. Never “Untitled”: use the first line, file name cleaned up, or “Voice memo · date”.
- **Meta:** type · collection · time, in the app language.
- **“In chat”:** Mint pill when the item is attached to the current conversation (was “Context”).
- **Favorite:** Apricot heart on dark only.
- **Long-press:** multi-select; swipe left: archive.

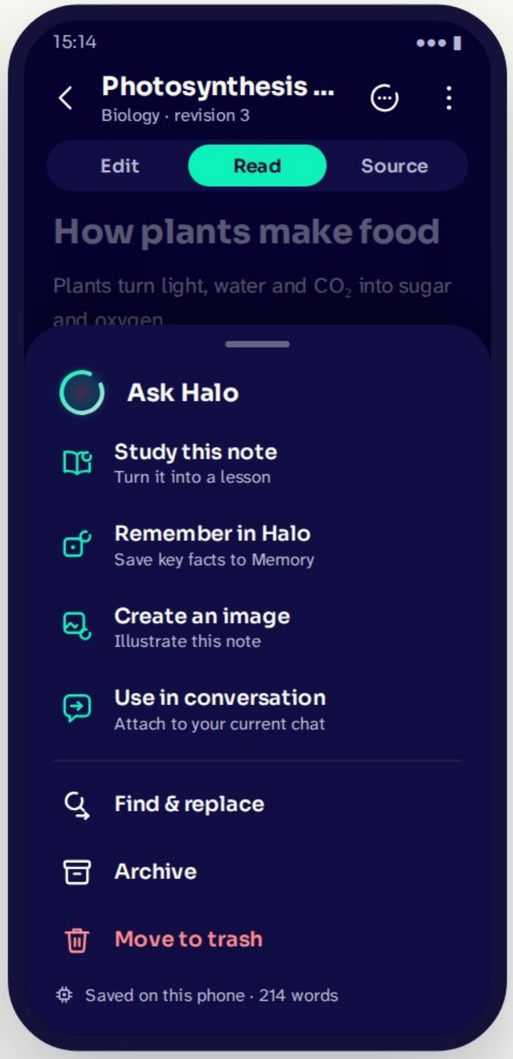
NOTEBOOK & TOOLS · 03

Note editor

Writing first. Tools appear where the hands are, and Halo's help lives in one place with one marker.



Edit mode



Ask Halo sheet

EDITOR RULES

Top bar: back · title + collection/revision · **Think with Halo** (ring with dots) · more.

Mode switch: Edit / Read / Source as one segmented control. Read hides all tools.

Formatting bar sits on the keyboard, only while editing: undo · heading · bold · italic · bullets · numbers · quote · link · code · attach. Paragraph style lives in the heading button.

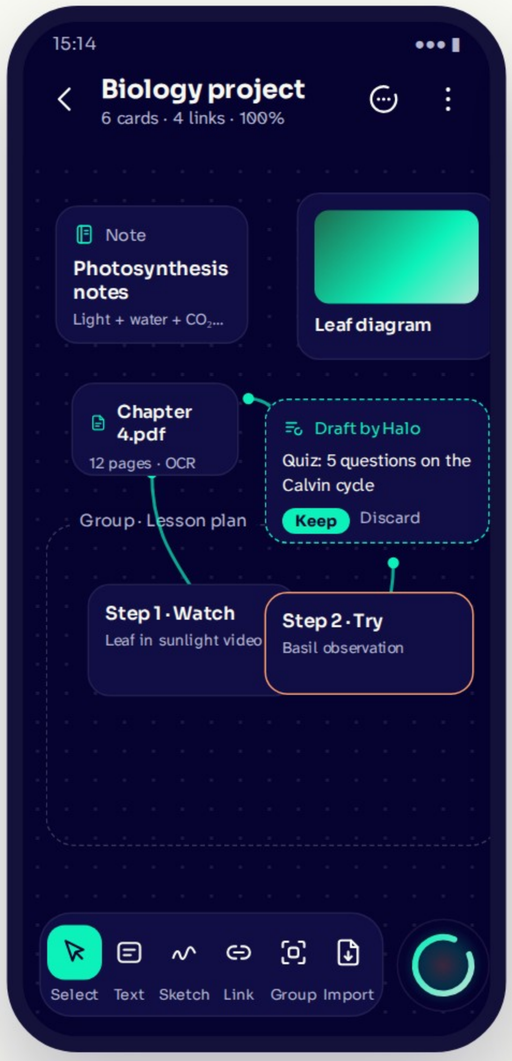
Ask Halo sheet: every AI action wears the open-ring marker, so people always know what Halo will touch. File actions sit below a divider; trash is the only warm-red row and asks to confirm.

Status: "Saved on this phone" with the on-device icon, words, revision. Honest and always visible in the sheet and Read mode.

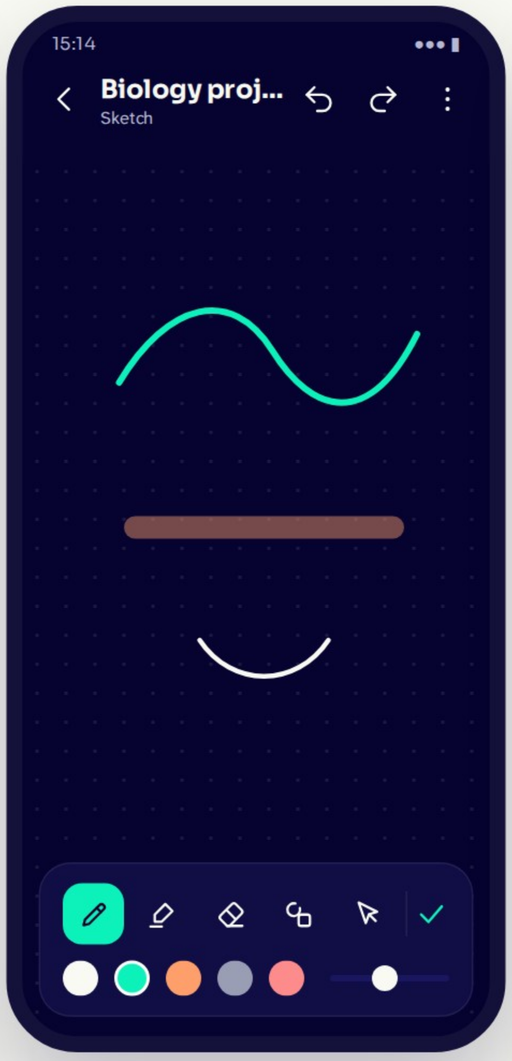
NOTEBOOK & TOOLS · 04

Canvas

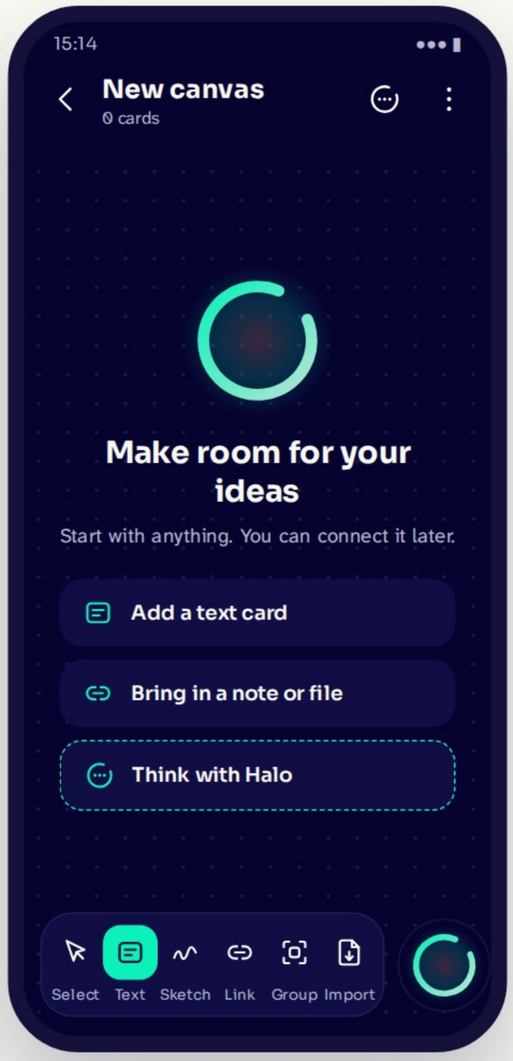
One dock for every tool, Halo one tap away. Card types read at a glance: notes, images, files, groups, and Halo drafts with a dashed Mint border until you keep them. Connections end in Mint dots.



Canvas · cards, groups, links



Sketch mode

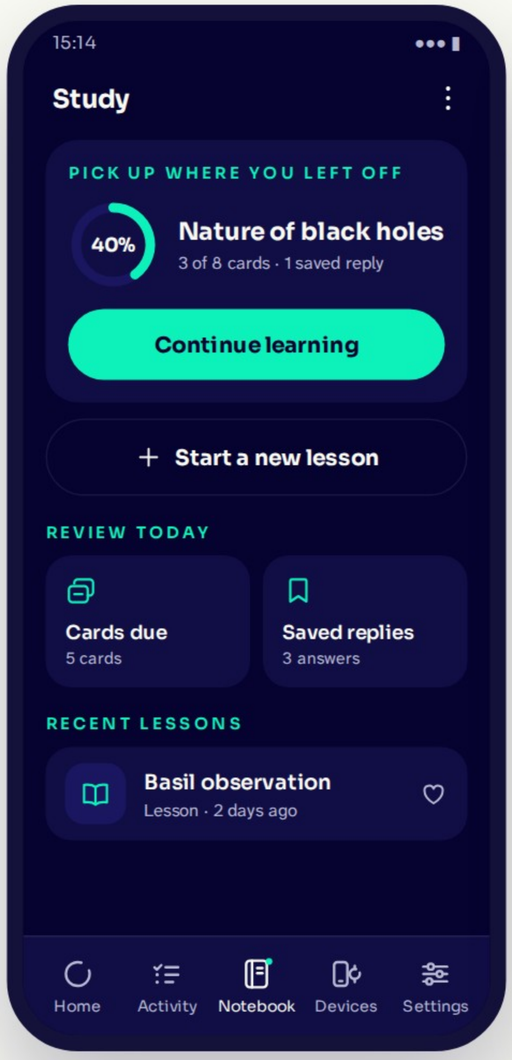


Empty canvas

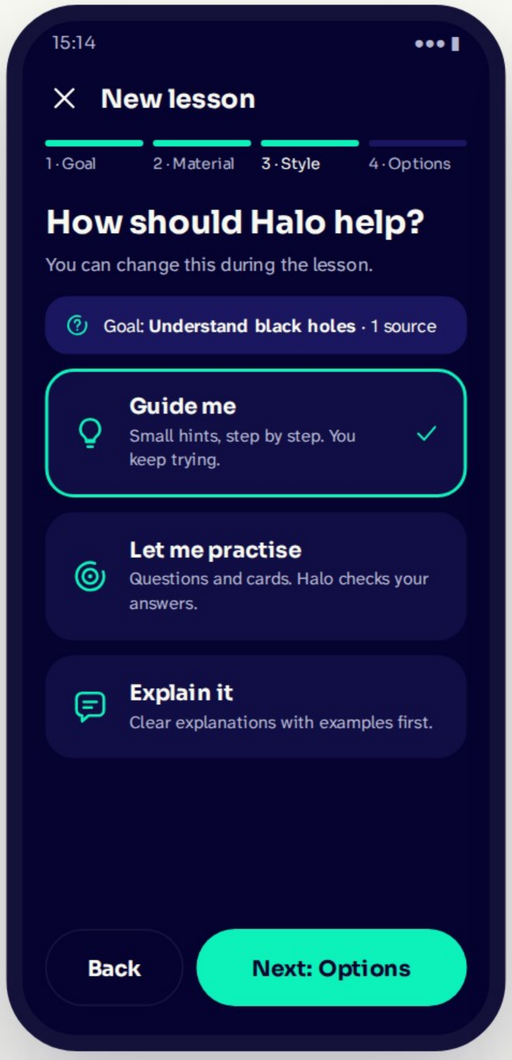
NOTEBOOK & TOOLS · 05

Study

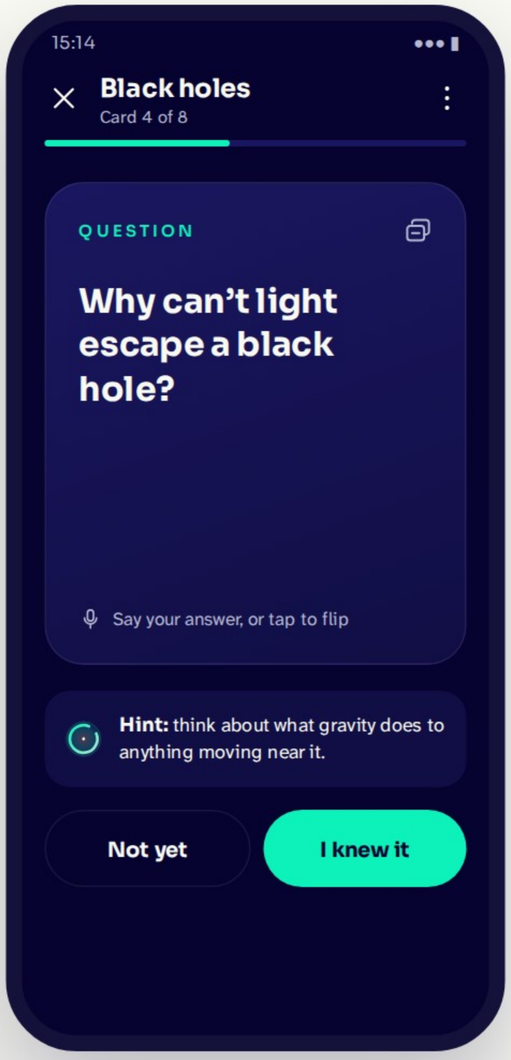
Continue first, then start new. The long setup form becomes a 4-step stepper, and practice cards keep Halo beside you: voice answers, gentle hints, two honest buttons.



Study home



New lesson · step 3



Practice card

NOTEBOOK & TOOLS · 06

51 new icons

Same hand as the core set: 24dp, 1.75 stroke, Open Ring gap on circles. Halo actions all carry the small open ring. Library now has 133 icons.

EDITOR

bold · italic · heading · bullet-list · numbered-list · quote · code

find-replace · undo · redo · read-mode · source · add-block

CANVAS & SKETCH

select · card · connection · sketch · draw · highlighter · eraser

shapes · link · group · fit-all · zoom-in

STUDY

guide-me · practise · explain · flashcard · quiz · review · sources

saved-reply

LIBRARY

filter · grid-view · list-view · calendar · file-doc · file-audio · saved-chat

HALO ACTIONS

create-image · use-in-chat · remember · think-with-halo · study-this

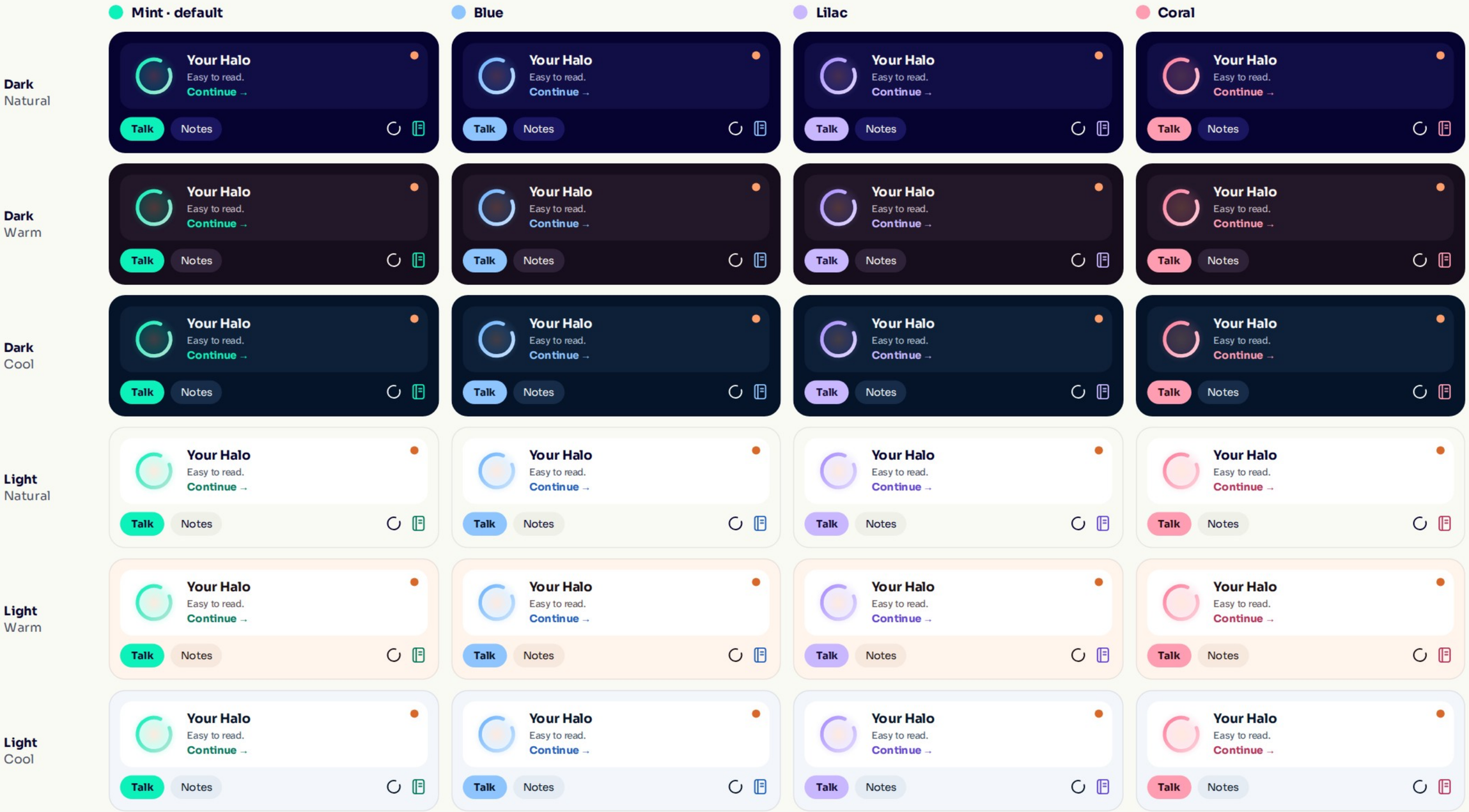
BASICS

back · add · close · check · more · chevron-down

APPEARANCE · 01

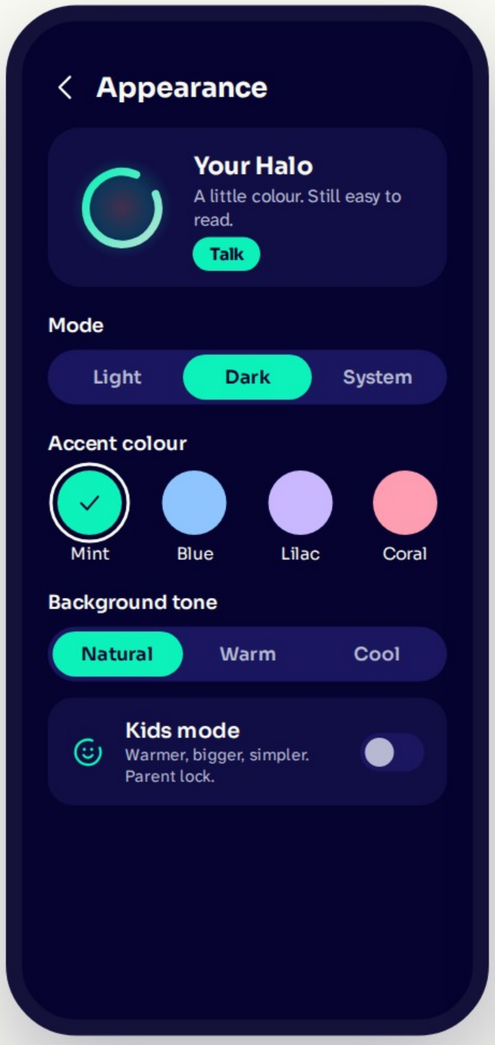
24 themes, one Halo

Your Appearance settings (Light/Dark × 4 accents × 3 background tones) mapped to brand-safe colors. Every combination passes WCAG AA for text and controls.

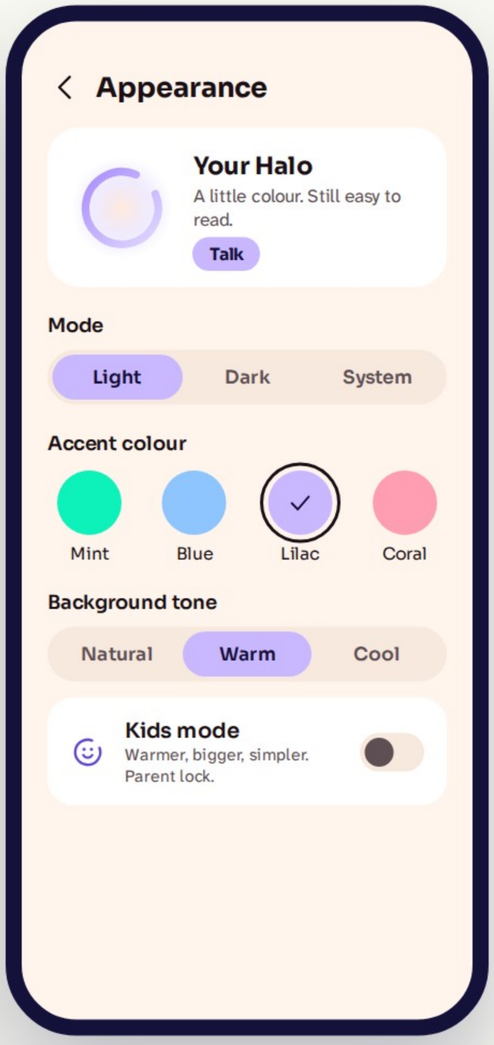


APPEARANCE · 02

Personal, still on-brand



Dark · Natural · Mint (default)



Light · Warm · Lilac

Accent changes

Buttons, selected chips, links, progress, the active-tab dot, and the in-app orb ring.

Accent never changes

The logo, launcher icon and marketing (always Halo Mint), plus the meaning colours: Apricot = Halo needs you, red = error.

Coral, retuned

Your current Coral (#F5BEA9) sits right next to Apricot, so "accent" and "needs you" would look the same. Coral moves to rose #FF9EB3, clearly apart.

Light mode text

Accents are pastel fills with dark text on top. As text or icons on light backgrounds, each accent has an ink shade: Mint #047A5E, Blue #1F5FBF, Lilac #6446D6, Coral #B8325A.

Background tones

Natural = brand Night Ink / Cream. Warm and Cool shift the background and surfaces only; text keeps AA.

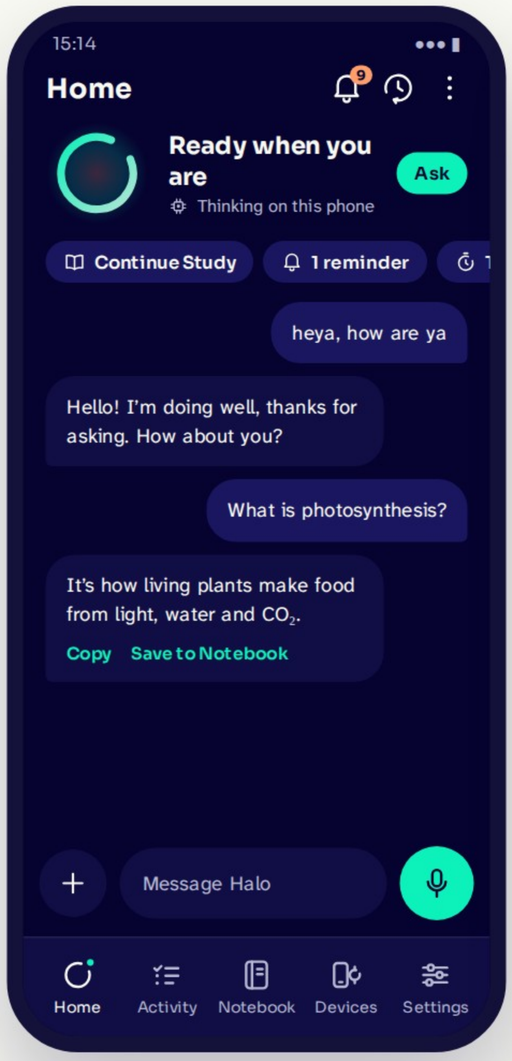
Kids mode

Defaults to the Warm tone and keeps the Mint→Apricot kids ring regardless of accent. Parents can still change the tone.

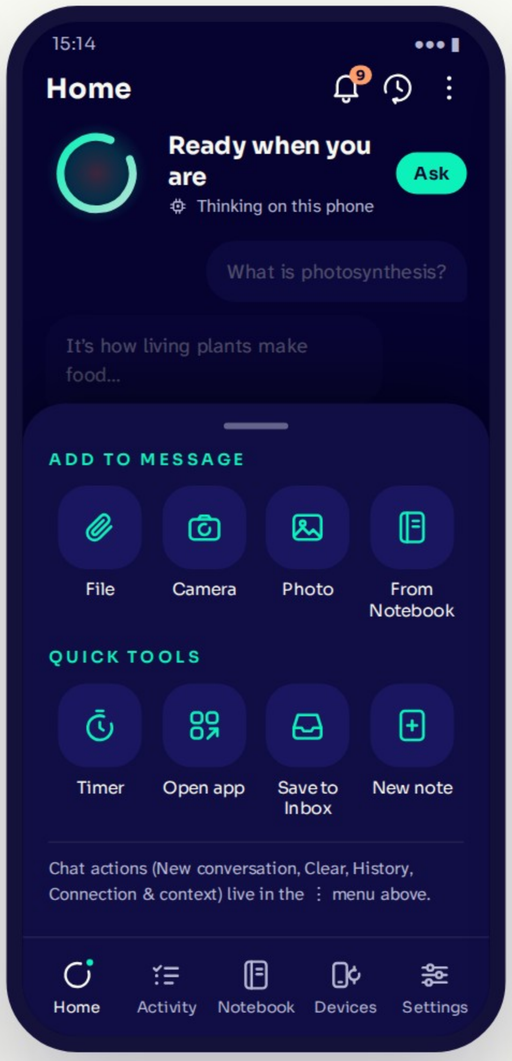
HALO'S TOOLS · 02

Home: the conversation

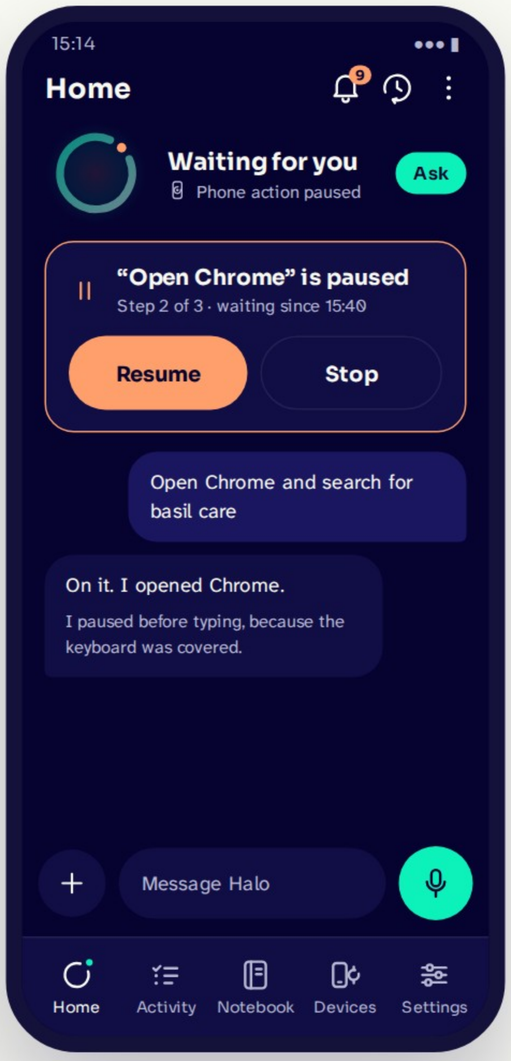
Home becomes a real chat with Halo's presence on top: state, where it's thinking, and an Ask / Act switch. Tools live behind "+", chat actions in the menu, and a paused task gets one clear banner with an Apricot edge.



Home · conversation



"+" tools & attachments

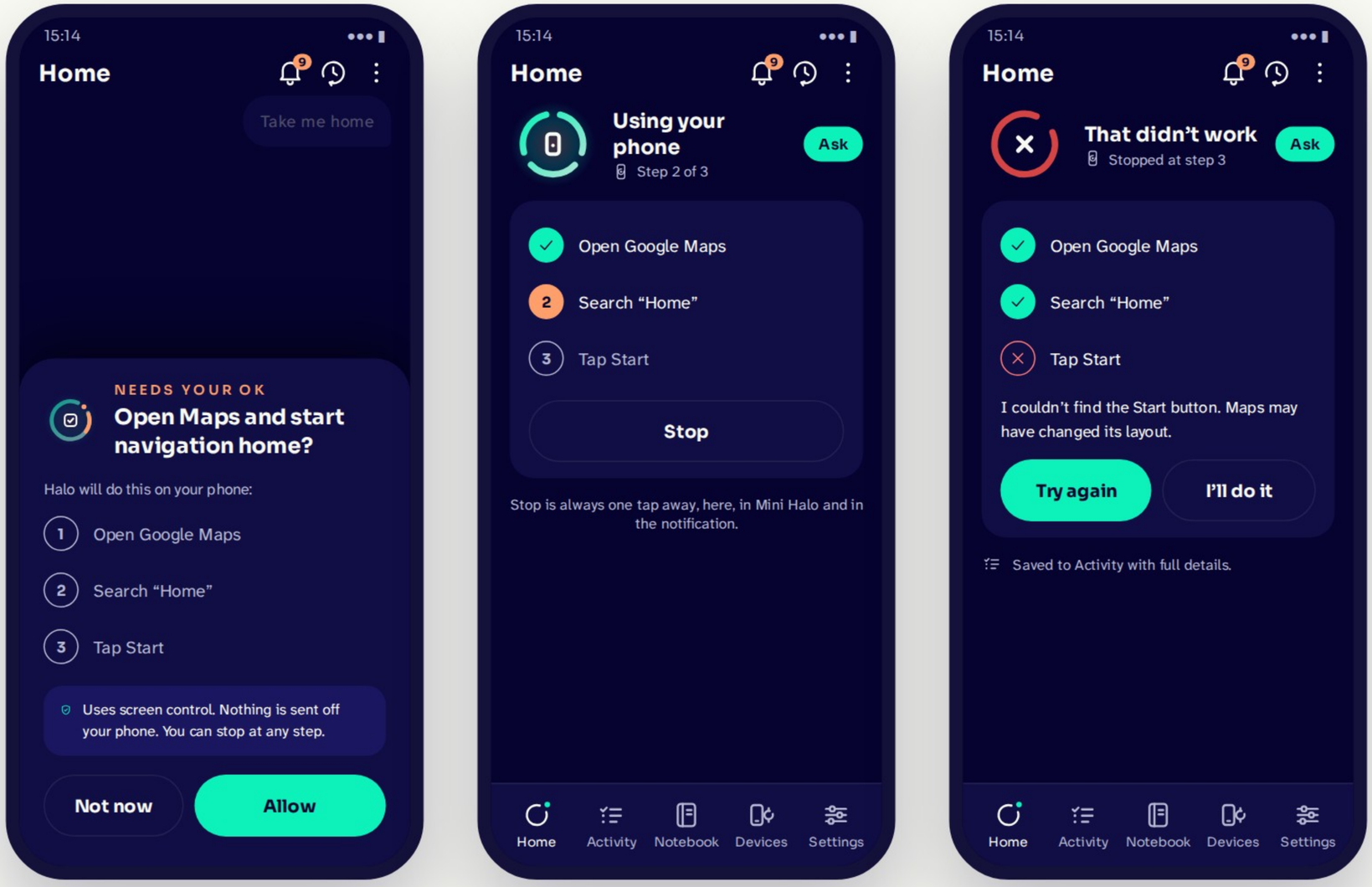


Paused task

HALO'S TOOLS · 03

Approve, act, recover

Before a phone action, Halo shows the exact steps and what it will touch. While it works, the steps tick off with Stop always visible. When it fails, it says what happened in plain words and offers a way forward.



Approval sheet

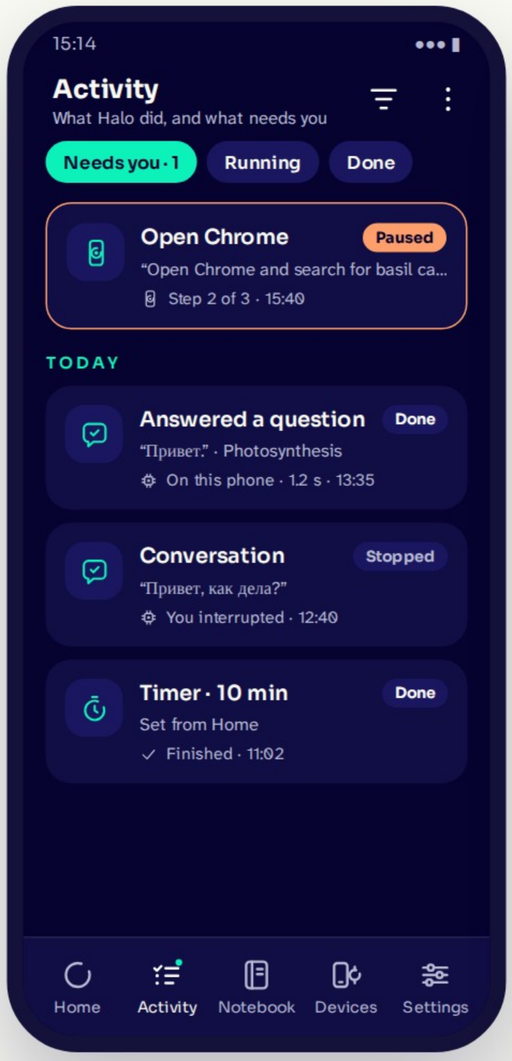
Action running

Failure & recovery

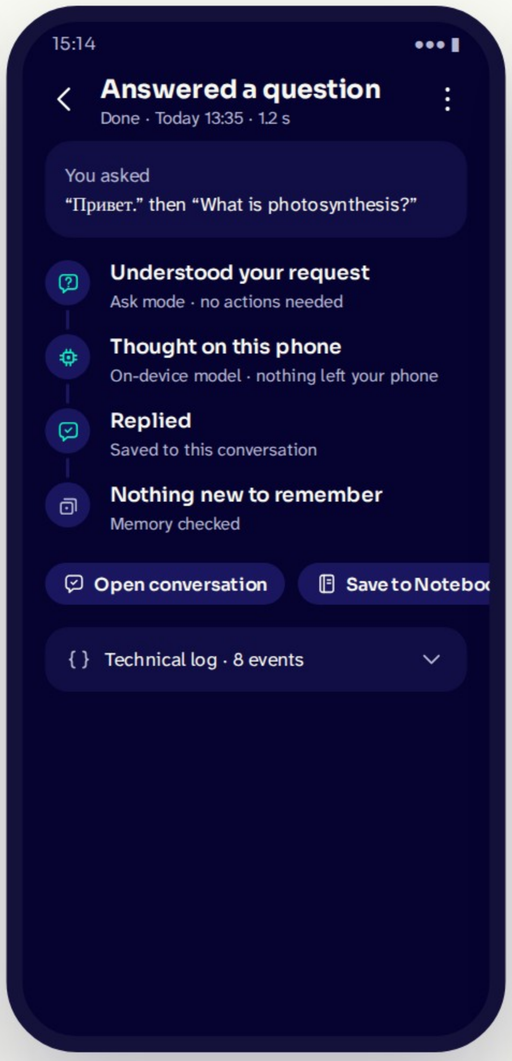
HALO'S TOOLS · 04

Activity: what Halo did

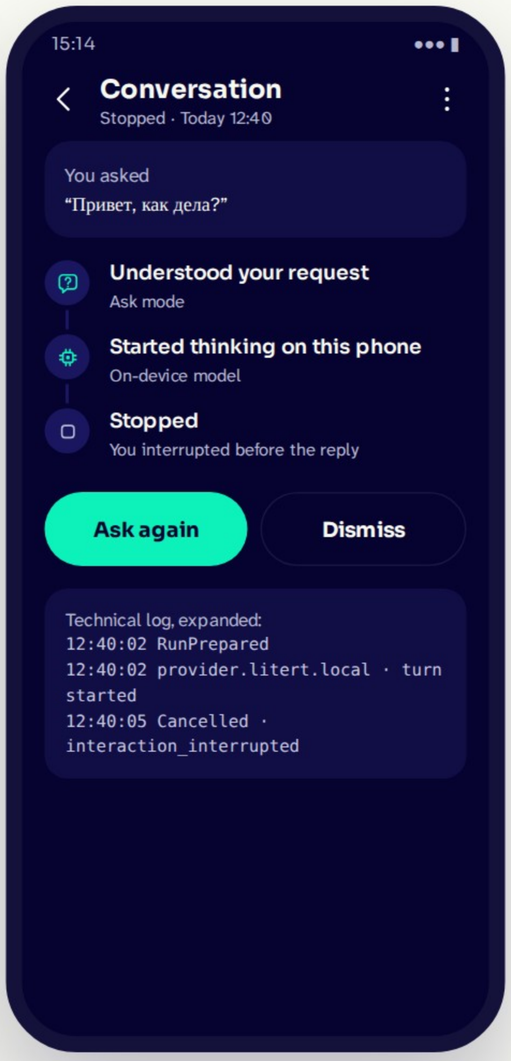
Three tabs (Needs you · Running · Done). Each run gets a human title, a status chip, where it ran and how long it took. Details tell the story in four steps; the raw log stays one tap away for developers and curious testers.



Activity list



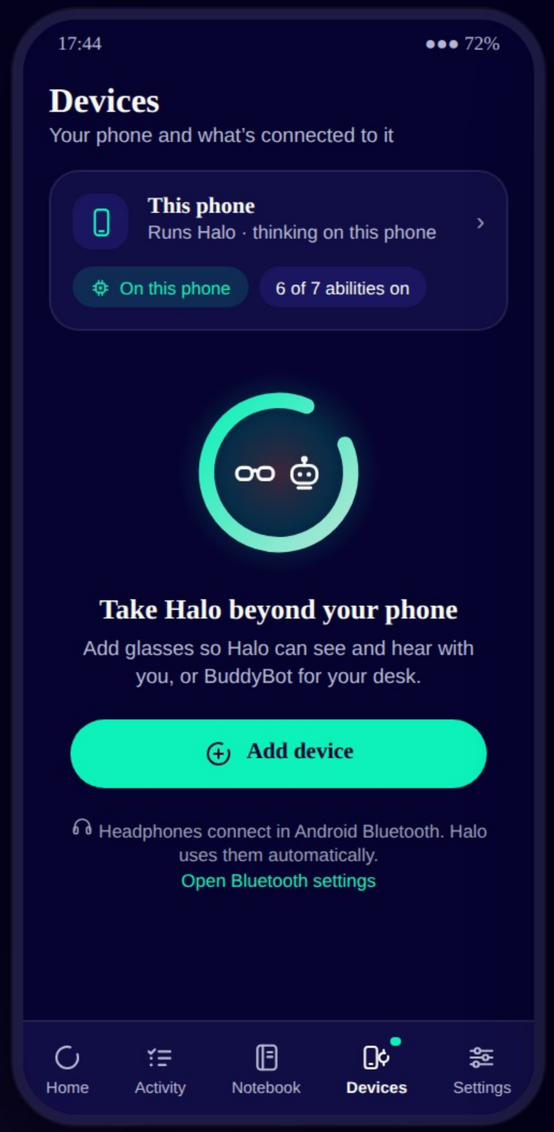
Run details



Stopped run · log open

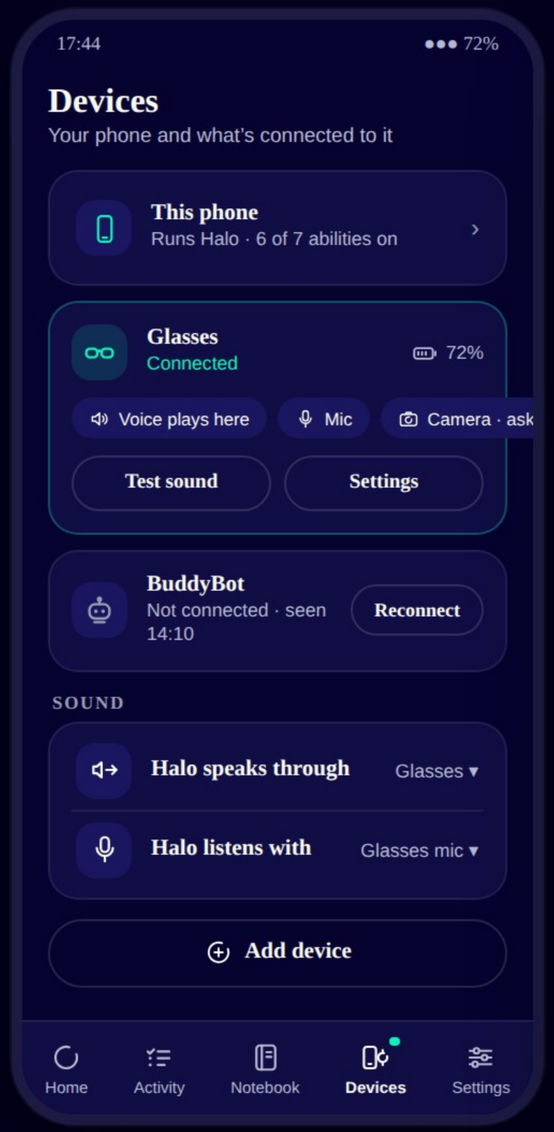
Devices: one place for everything Halo works with

The Devices tab answers three questions at a glance: what's connected, is it working, and where does Halo's voice come from.



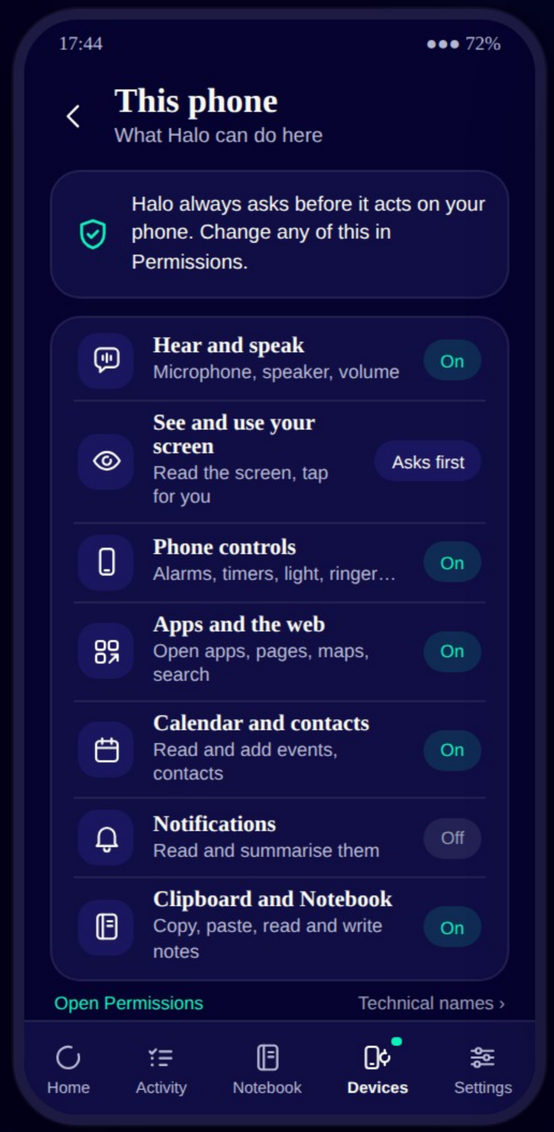
Devices · first run

"This phone" shows where Halo thinks and how much it can do. The empty state sells the why, and headphones get a real link.



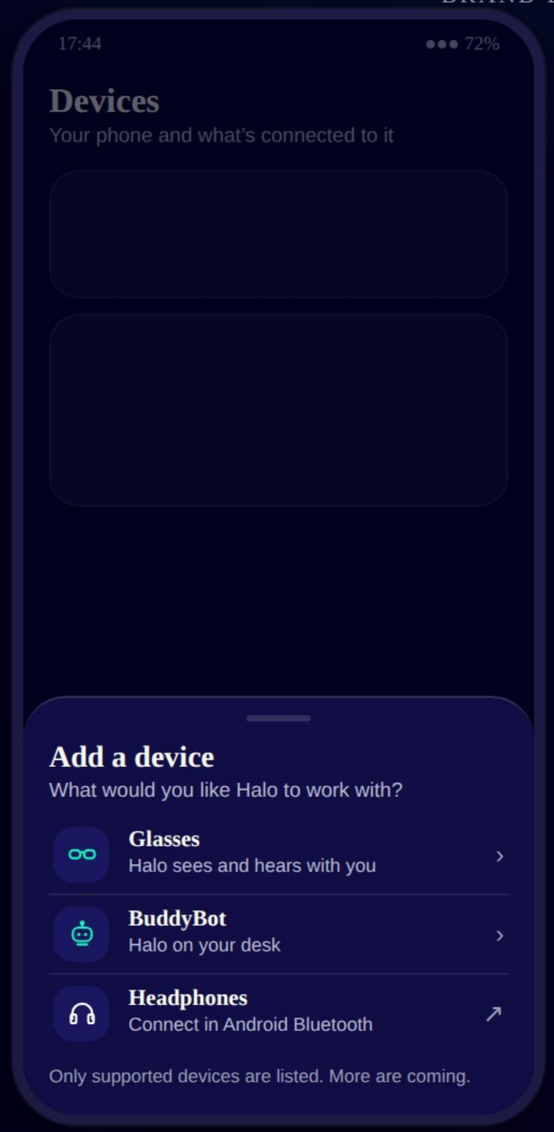
Devices · connected

Each device shows state, battery and what it's doing for Halo. Not connected is calm grey, never red. Sound routing lives here too.



This phone · abilities

The 33 internal names become 7 abilities with on / asks first / off. The raw list stays one tap away for developers.



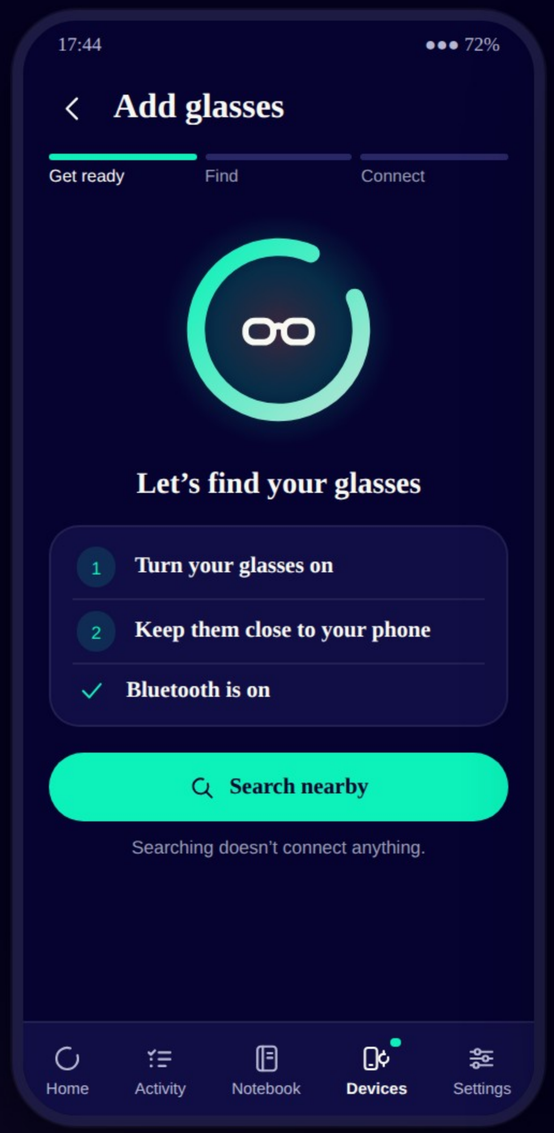
Add device

One chooser for glasses, BuddyBot and headphones. Headphones hand off to Android with an ↗ so it's clear you're leaving Halo.

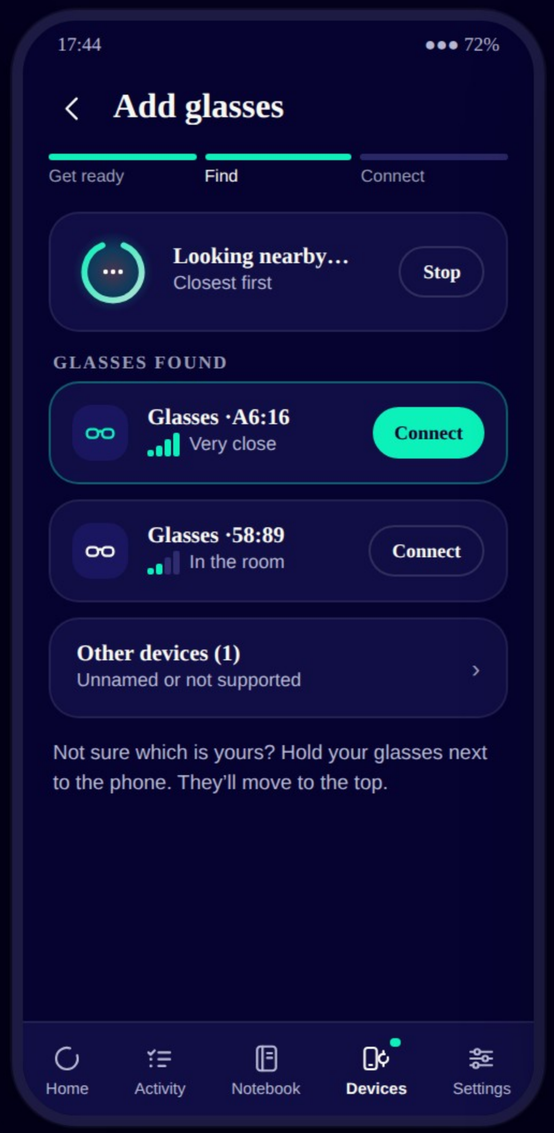
HALO · DEVICES

Pairing glasses: three steps, no guesswork

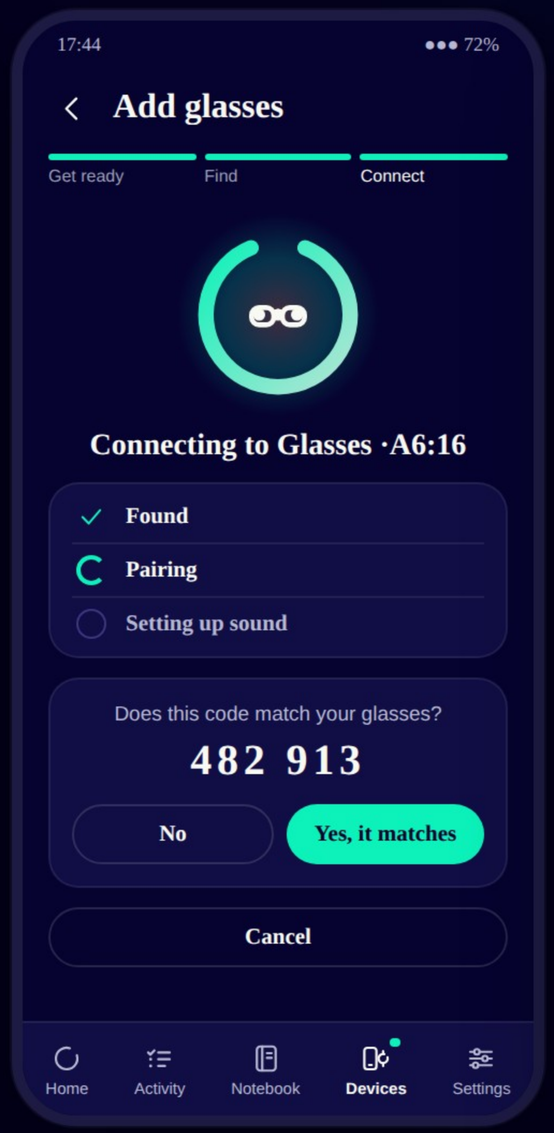
One flow, the same for every supported device. BuddyBot uses the same three steps with its own picture.



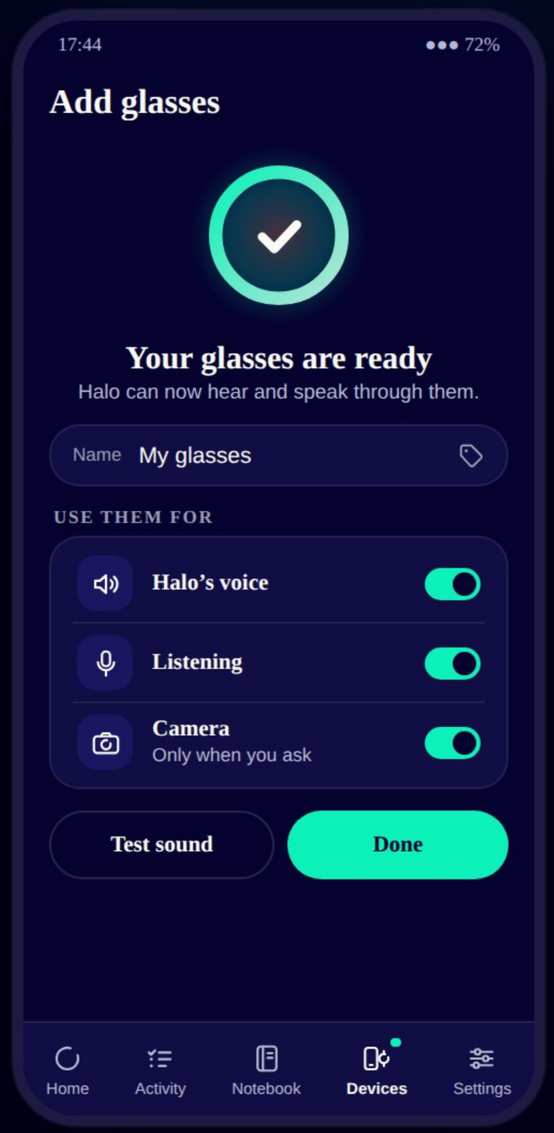
1 · Get ready
A three-step checklist. Bluetooth is checked for the user, not explained to them.



2 · Find
Glasses only, closest first, with signal bars and the last 4 address characters to tell twins apart. Stop is neutral.



3 · Connect
Progress in plain steps. The code check only appears if the glasses show a code.



Ready
A success ring, a friendly name, and three clear switches. Camera defaults to “only when you ask”.

IF IT DOESN’T WORK

Couldn’t connect
Your glasses may still be paired to another phone. Forget them there, then try again.
Try again

Glasses went quiet
They may have switched off or moved away. Bring them closer.
Search again

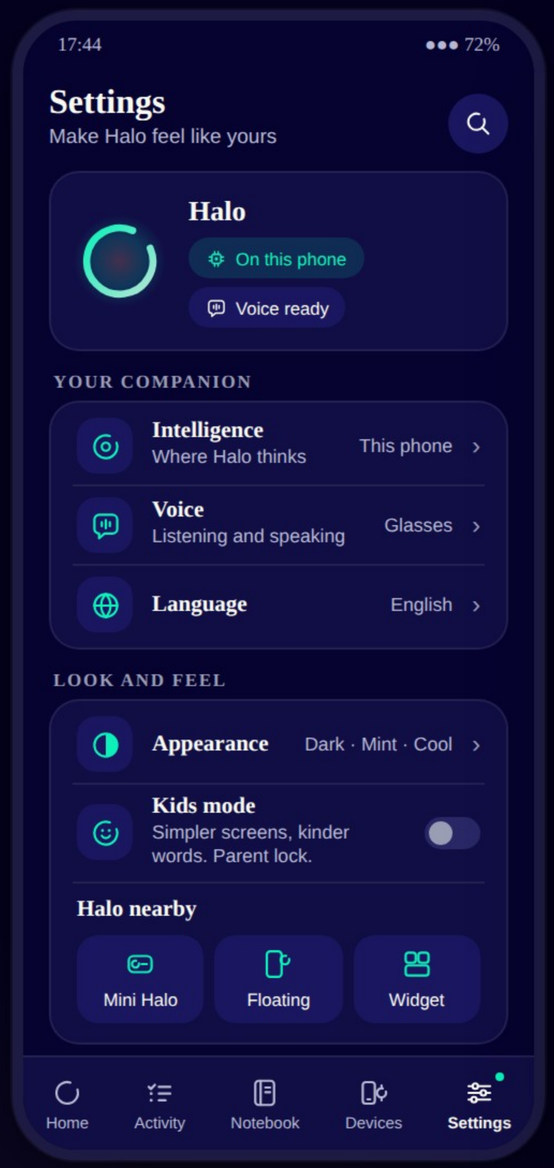
Not supported yet
Halo can’t use these glasses yet. We’ll tell you when it can.
OK

Red only for a real failure. Never a dead end: every message has a next step.

HALO · SETTINGS

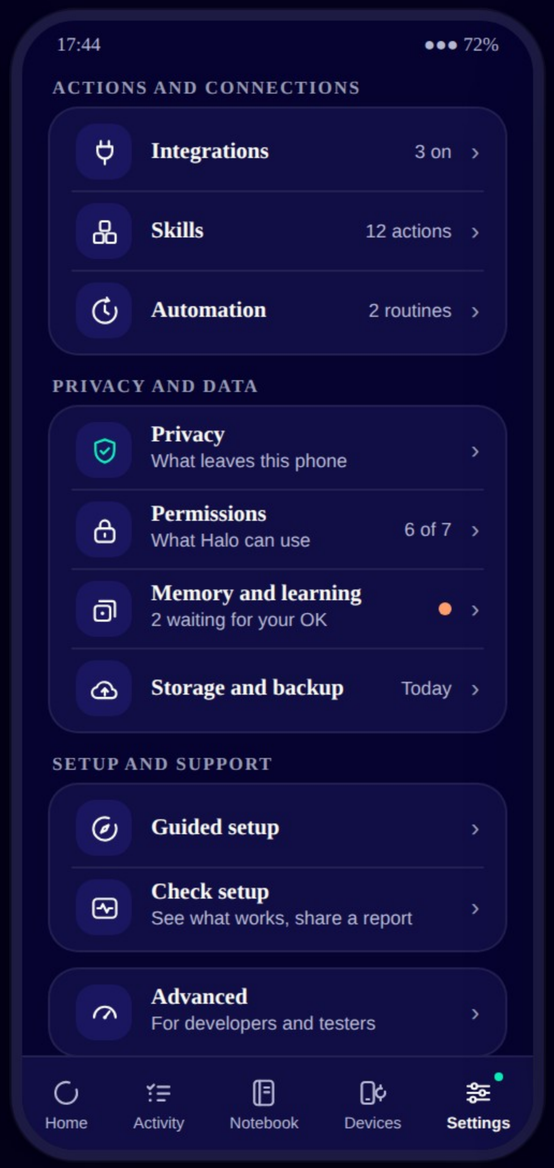
Settings and the Intelligence centre

Shorter, searchable, and grouped by what people want to change, not by how Halo is built.



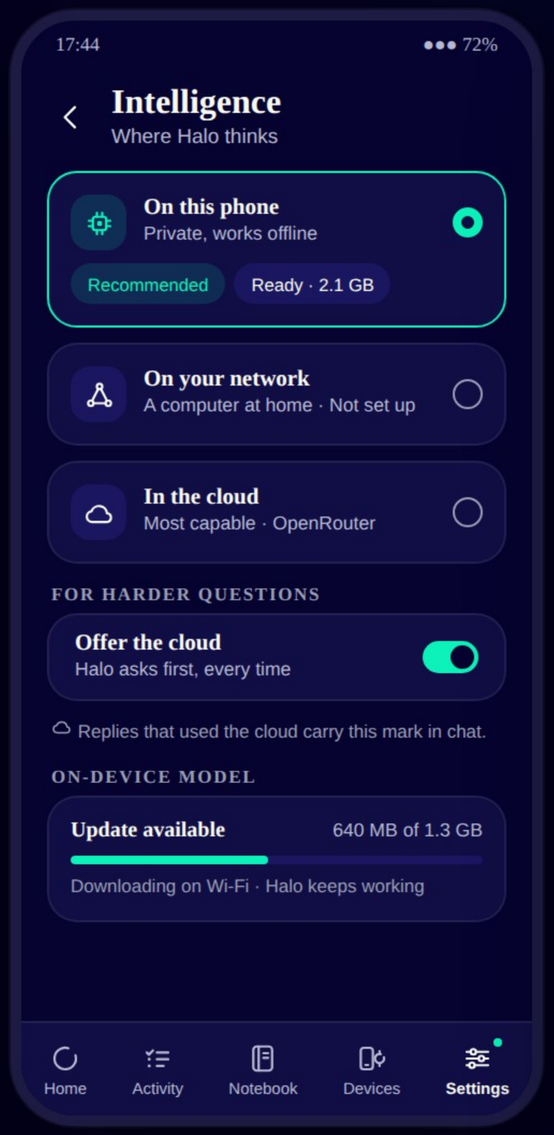
Settings · top

Search, a status card that answers “where does Halo think?”, and the current value on every row.



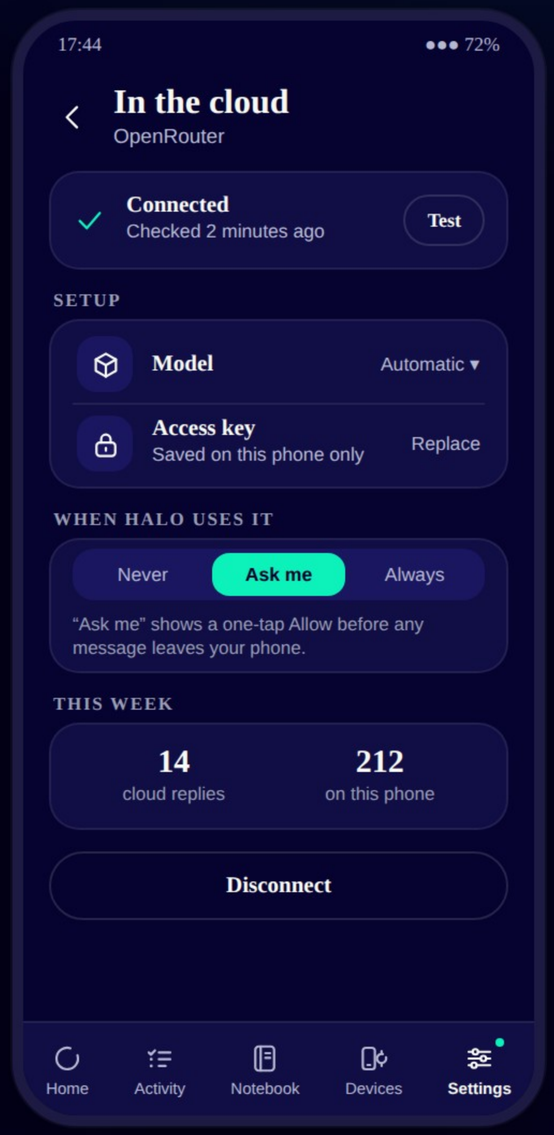
Settings · rest

Privacy gets its own home and every row its own icon. Memory waiting for you gets the Apricot dot. Advanced is the last row.



Intelligence

Three places to think, one clear choice. The cloud is never preselected; a model download never blocks Halo.



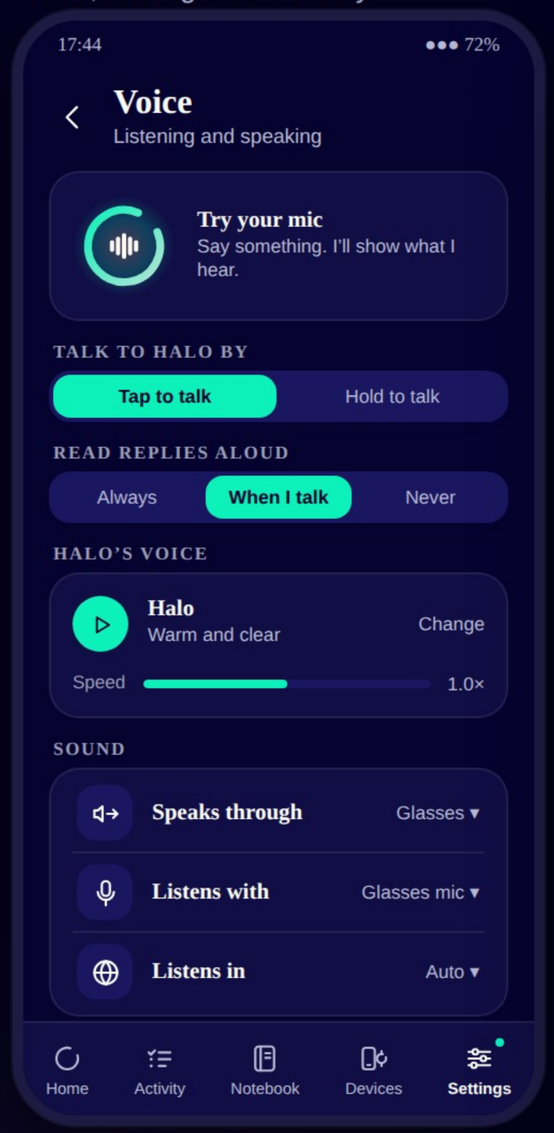
Cloud provider

Connection, model, key and usage on one screen. “Ask me” is the default.

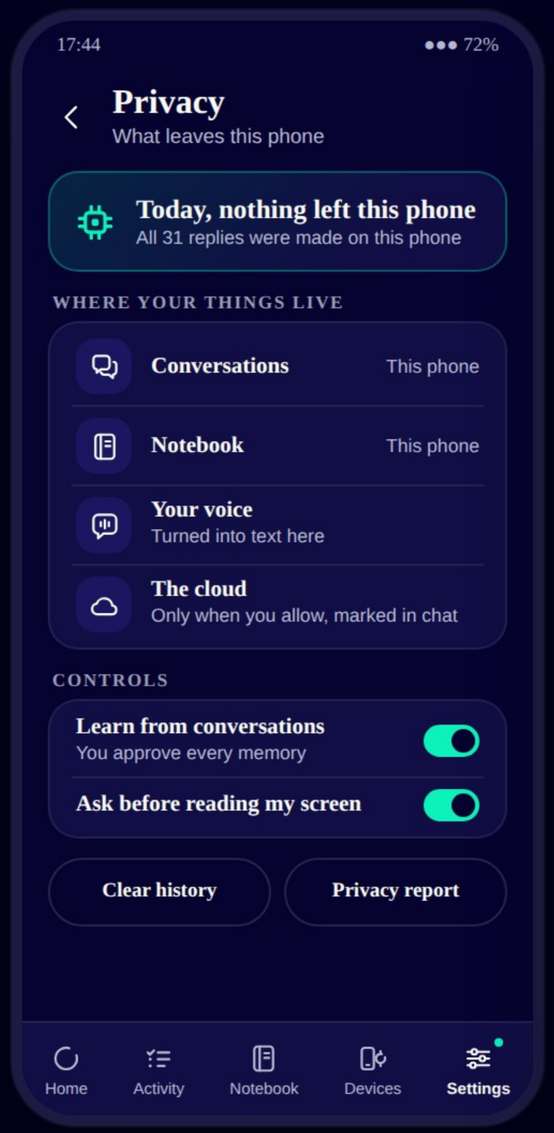
HALO · SETTINGS

Voice, Privacy, Permissions and Advanced

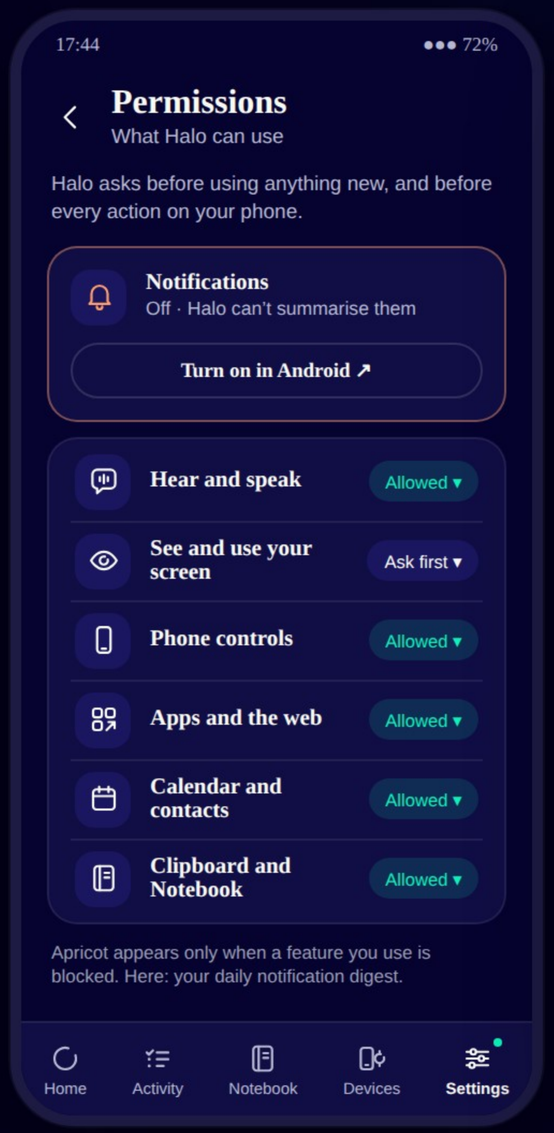
Same words everywhere: the abilities in Permissions match Devices, and “on this phone” means the same thing on Home, Settings and Privacy.



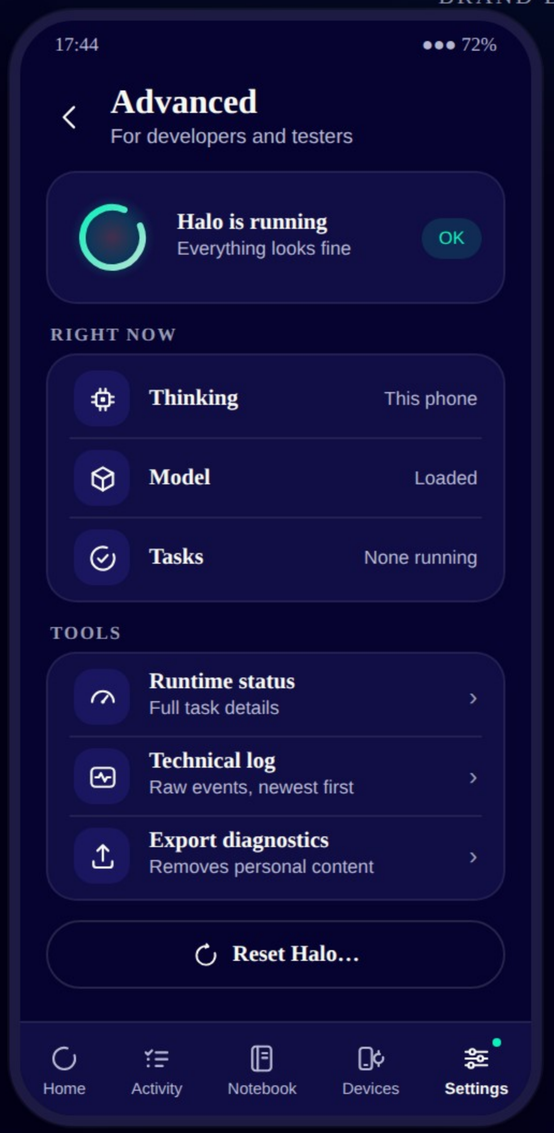
Voice
A live mic test, two simple choices, Halo’s own voice with speed, and the same sound routing as Devices.



Privacy
Leads with the answer people want: did anything leave my phone today? Then where each kind of data lives.



Permissions
The same 7 abilities as Devices, each with Allowed / Ask first / Off. Apricot only when something you use is blocked.



Advanced
Runtime status reads like a health check first. Raw logs and exports stay here, away from everyday settings. Reset always confirms.